

Sequenzanalyse 2

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CHAPTER 1

Sequence Comparison Beyond Edit Distance

The **edit distance** (or **alignment distance**) is one of the most fundamental ways of quantifying the dissimilarity of two sequences x and y over a finite alphabet Σ . It is based on the cost of an alignment $A = (A_1, A_2, \dots, A_n)$, defined as the sum of the costs of A 's columns, i.e.,

$$\text{cost}(A) = \sum_{i=1}^n \text{cost}(A_i),$$

where the cost of alignment column $A_i = \begin{pmatrix} a_i \\ b_i \end{pmatrix}$, $a_i, b_i \in \Sigma$, in the simplest (unit cost) case is 0 for a match column ($a_i = b_i$), and 1 for a mismatch column ($a_i \neq b_i$) or an indel column ($a_i = -$ or $b_i = -$). Then we have:

Definition 1.1 Alignment distance The alignment distance of two sequences $x, y \in \Sigma^*$ is defined as $d(x, y) := \min\{\text{cost}(A) : A \in \mathcal{A}^*$ is an alignment of x and $y\}$.

The corresponding computational problem is as follows:

Problem 1.1 Alignment Problem

For two given strings $x, y \in \Sigma^*$ and a given cost function, find the alignment distance of x and y and one or all optimal alignment(s).

From the “Sequence Analysis 1” lecture we know that this problem can be solved in $O(mn)$ time using a simple and elegant dynamic programming algorithm, where $m = |x|$ and $n = |y|$ are the two sequence lengths.

However, there are situations in which **edit distance** and alignments are not the perfect model to compare sequences. In the following two sections we will study two interesting alternatives.

1.1 | The q -gram Distance

Idea 1.1 Die q -Gramm-Distanz vergleicht zwei Strings nicht zeichenweise, sondern über die Häufigkeiten aller Länge- q -Teilwörter. Sie ist sehr schnell ($O(n)$) und dient als Filter für die (teure) Editdistanz.

Edit distances emphasize the correct order of the characters in a string. If, however, a large block of a text is moved somewhere else (e.g. two paragraphs of a text are exchanged), the **edit distance** will be high, although from a certain standpoint, the texts are still quite similar. A more appropriate notion of distance can be defined in several ways. Here we introduce the **q -gram distance** d_q , which is actually a pseudo-metric: There exist strings $x \neq y$ with $d_q(x, y) = 0$.

Remember that for $q \in \mathbb{N}$, a **q -gram** is a string of length q . Wir reden hier über überlappende q -gramme!

Definition 1.2 occurrence count Let $x \in \Sigma^m$ and choose $q \in [1, m]$. The occurrence count of a q -gram $z \in \Sigma^q$ in x is the number

$$Occ(x, z) := |\{i \in [1, m - q + 1] : x[i \dots i + q - 1] = z\}| \quad (1.1)$$

Definition 1.3 Q-gram profile Let $\sigma = |\Sigma|$. The q -gram profile of x is a σ^q -element vector $p_q(x) := (p_q(x)_z)_{z \in \Sigma^q}$, indexed by all q -grams, defined by $p_q(x)_z := Occ(x, z)$.

Comment 1.1 Also eine geordnete Liste davon, wie oft ein q -gram in einem Wort vorkam.

Definition 1.4 q-gram distance The q -gram distance of $x \in \Sigma^m$ and $y \in \Sigma^n$ is defined for $1 \leq q \leq \min\{m, n\}$ as:

$$d_q(x, y) := \sum_{z \in \Sigma^q} |p_q(x)_z - p_q(y)_z| \quad (1.2)$$

Comment 1.2 Einfacher/Umgangssprachlicher:

$$d_q(x, y) := \sum_{\text{every } q\text{-gram } z} |Occ(x, z) - Occ(y, z)|$$

bzw. noch etwas weiter verunstaltet:

$$d_q(x, y) := \sum_{\text{every } q\text{-gram}} |\#x - \#y|$$

Example 1.1 Consider $\Sigma = A, B$, $x = ABAA$, $y = ABAB$, $z = AABA$, and $q = 2$. Using lexicographic order (AA, AB, BA, BB) among the q -grams, we have $p_2(x) = (1, 1, 1, 0)$, $p_2(y) = (0, 2, 1, 0)$ and $p_2(z) = (1, 1, 1, 0)$. Therefore, we obtain $d_2(x, y) = 2$ and $d_2(x, z) = 0$ (although $x \neq z$).

Theorem 1.1 The q -gram distance d_q is a pseudo-metric.

Proof. It fulfills nonnegativity, symmetry and the triangle inequality (exercise).

1.1.1 | Practical Computation

If the q -gram profile of a string $x \in \Sigma^m$ is **dense** (i.e., if it does not contain mostly zeros), it makes sense to implement it as an array $p[0 \dots \Sigma^q - 1]$, where $p[i]$ counts the number of occurrences of the i -th q -gram in some arbitrary but fixed (e.g. lexicographic) order.

Definition 1.5 Ranking function A bijective function $r : \mathcal{X} \rightarrow [0, |\mathcal{X}| - 1]$ for a finite set $\mathcal{X}$.

Comment 1.3 Warum $|\mathcal{X}| - 1$?

Definition 1.6 Ranking algorithm An algorithm that implements a ranking function.

Definition 1.7 Unranking function The inverse of a ranking function.

Definition 1.8 Unranking algorithm An algorithm that implements a unranking function.

Of course, we are interested in an efficient (un-)ranking algorithm for the set of all q -grams over Σ . A classical one is to first define a **ranking function** r_Σ on the characters (alphabet encoding) and then extend it to a **ranking function**

r on the q -grams by interpreting them as base- σ numbers. There are two possibilities to number the positions of a q -gram: From q to 1 falling or from 1 to q rising, as shown in the Example 1.2.

Comment 1.4 Was sind base- σ numbers?

Example 1.2 Assume the alphabet $\Sigma = A, C, G, T$ and the alphabet encoding $r_\Sigma(A) = 0, r_\Sigma(C) = 1, r_\Sigma(G) = 2$, and $r_\Sigma(T) = 3$. For $q = 5$, the two different possibilities to rank the q -gram $z = \text{ATACG}$ are:

(a) Falling ranking

$$\begin{aligned} r(ATACG) &= \underbrace{r_\Sigma(z[1]) \cdot \sigma^4}_{0 \cdot 4^4} + \underbrace{r_\Sigma(z[2]) \cdot \sigma^3}_{3 \cdot 4^3} + \underbrace{r_\Sigma(z[3]) \cdot \sigma^2}_{0 \cdot 4^2} + \underbrace{r_\Sigma(z[4]) \cdot \sigma^1}_{1 \cdot 4^1} + \underbrace{r_\Sigma(z[5]) \cdot \sigma^0}_{2 \cdot 4^0} \\ &= 0 + 192 + 0 + 4 + 2 = 198 \end{aligned}$$

(b) Rising ranking

$$\begin{aligned} r(ATACG) &= \underbrace{r_\Sigma(z[1]) \cdot \sigma^0}_{0 \cdot 4^0} + \underbrace{r_\Sigma(z[2]) \cdot \sigma^1}_{3 \cdot 4^1} + \underbrace{r_\Sigma(z[3]) \cdot \sigma^2}_{0 \cdot 4^2} + \underbrace{r_\Sigma(z[4]) \cdot \sigma^3}_{1 \cdot 4^3} + \underbrace{r_\Sigma(z[5]) \cdot \sigma^4}_{2 \cdot 4^4} \\ &= 0 + 12 + 0 + 64 + 512 = 588 \end{aligned}$$

The first numbering of positions in (a) corresponds naturally to the ordering of positional number systems; in the decimal number 23, the first 2 has positional value (weight) $10^1 = 10$ whereas the 3 has the lower weight of $10^0 = 1$. For texts, however, the second numbering in (b) is more natural since we expect lower position numbers on the left side of higher position numbers.

In general, we see that $z \in \Sigma^q$ has rank

$$r(z) = \sum_{i=1}^q r_\Sigma(z[i]) \cdot \sigma^{q-i} \quad (1.3)$$

(falling) or

$$r(z) = \sum_{i=1}^q r_\Sigma(z[i]) \cdot \sigma^{i-1} \quad (1.4)$$

(rising).

Whichever numbering system we use, we have to do it consistently.

For each of the two ways to rank a q -gram, there is a corresponding unranking method. Both methods work with integer division and remainder. The one for the falling ranking function uses a dynamic divisor and determines the characters of the q -gram based on the integer results, the other one for the rising ranking function uses a fixed divisor and determines the characters based on the remainder.

Example 1.3 Unranking the rank values 198 and 588 from Example 1.2.

(a) Unranking for falling ranking function

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{198}{4^4} &= 0, \quad \text{R } 198 \rightarrow A \\ \frac{198}{4^3} &= 3, \quad \text{R } 6 \rightarrow T \\ \frac{6}{4^2} &= 0, \quad \text{R } 6 \rightarrow A \\ \frac{6}{4^1} &= 1, \quad \text{R } 2 \rightarrow C \\ \frac{2}{4^0} &= 0, \quad \text{R } 0 \rightarrow G \end{aligned}$$

(b) Unranking for rising ranking function

$$\begin{aligned}\frac{588}{4} &= 147, & \text{R } 0 &\rightarrow A \\ \frac{147}{4} &= 36, & \text{R } 3 &\rightarrow T \\ \frac{36}{4} &= 9, & \text{R } 0 &\rightarrow A \\ \frac{9}{4} &= 2, & \text{R } 1 &\rightarrow C \\ \frac{2}{4} &= 0, & \text{R } 2 &\rightarrow G\end{aligned}$$

Comment 1.5 To example 1.3.

$$\frac{198}{4^4} = 0, \quad \text{R } 198 \rightarrow A$$

Because $\frac{198}{4^4} = \frac{198}{256} \approx 0,77$ which means the rest (R) is 198, since $198 - 0 = 198$. We decode it into A, since we are using the result of the fraction to find the letters: $r_\Sigma(A) = 0$.

$$\frac{588}{4} = 147, \quad \text{R } 0 \rightarrow A$$

Because with the rising function we are using the rest to find the letters instead of the result of the fraction.

Both methods need q iterations and reconstruct the q -gram from the first position to the last. Each iteration takes a starting value r and determines the corresponding character of the q -gram while updating r for the next iteration. The starting value for the first iteration is the rank of the q -gram. In iteration i in the unranking method (1.5), for $1 \leq i \leq q$, the starting value r is divided by σ^{q-i} . The integer result c of the division determines the decoded character as described by r_Σ of the used ranking function. The remainder r' of the division serves as starting value for the next iteration.

$$\frac{r}{\sigma^{q-1}} = c, \quad \text{R } r' \tag{1.5}$$

In unranking method (1.6), the starting value r is always divided by σ . Here, the remainder c of the integer division decodes the corresponding character and the integer result r' is the starting value for the next iteration.

$$\frac{r}{\sigma} = r', \quad \text{R } c \tag{1.6}$$

1.1.2 | Choice of q

In principle, we could use any $q \in [1, \min\{m, n\}]$ (Any q that is only as long as the shorter of the two strings being compared) to compare two strings of lengths m and n . In practice, some choices are more reasonable than others.

For example, for $q = 1$, we merely add the differences of the single letter counts. If m and n are large, there are many (even very differently looking) strings with the same letter counts, which would all have distance zero from each other.

If on the other hand $q = m \leq n$, and $m \approx n$, the distance d_q (q -gram distance) between the strings is always close to $n - m$, which does not give us a good resolution either. Also, the q -gram profile of both strings is extremely sparse in these cases. We thus ask for a value of q such that each q -gram occurs about once (or $c \geq 1$ times) on average.

Assuming a uniform random distribution of letters in a given string $x \in \Sigma^m$, the probability that a fixed q -gram z starts at a fixed position $i \in [1, m - q + 1]$ is $1/\sigma^q$, where $\sigma = |\Sigma|$.

Comment 1.6 It is NOT $1/\sigma$ (1 divided though the number of letters in the alphabet). One might think that, since at that “fixed position” (aka. any position) every letter of the alphabet can occur and if the distribution is uniform every letter has the same chance to occur there so it could start there, right? No. We have to account for the

length of the q -gram. The chance that the starting letter of the q -gram is at that position is $1/\sigma$. The chance that the second letter of the q -gram is in the position thereafter is $1/\sigma$. The chance that the third letter of the q -gram ...and so on. Meaning we have

$$\underbrace{1/\sigma \cdot 1/\sigma \cdots 1/\sigma}_{q \text{ times}} = 1/\sigma^q.$$

The expected number of occurrences of z in x is thus $(m - q + 1)/\sigma^q$.

Comment 1.7 Because there are $(m - q + 1)$ possible starting position for a q -gram in a string of length m .

The condition that this number equals c (The number each q -gram occurs approximately) leads to the condition $(m + 1)/c = q/c + \sigma^q$ (see Comment 1.8), or approximately $m/c = \sigma^q$, since $1/c$ and q/c are comparatively small.

Comment 1.8 It leads to the condition $(m + 1)/c = q/c + \sigma^q$, because:

$$\begin{aligned} \frac{(m - q + 1)}{\sigma^q} &= c & | \cdot \sigma^q \\ m - q + 1 &= c \cdot \sigma^q & | + q \\ m + 1 &= c \cdot \sigma^q + q & | : c \\ \frac{m + 1}{c} &= \sigma^q + \frac{q}{c} \end{aligned}$$

Thus setting

$$q = \left\lfloor \frac{\log(m) \log(c)}{\log(\sigma)} \right\rfloor$$

ensures an expected occurrence count $\geq c$ of each q -gram.

1.1.3 | Efficiency

Obviously, for $z \in \Sigma^q$, the ranking function $r(z)$ can be computed in $O(q)$ time. Both the falling and the rising ranking functions have the advantage that when a window of length q is shifted along a text, the rank of the q -gram can be updated in $O(1)$ time:

Assume that $t = aub$ with $a \in \Sigma$, $u \in \Sigma^{q-1}$ and $b \in \Sigma$. The first q -gram is au , whereas ub is the updated one. Now we can define an update system for each of the ranking systems above. Let $j = r(au)$. For the falling ranking function we compute:

$$(a) \ r(ub) = (j \bmod \sigma^{q-1}) \cdot \sigma + r_{\Sigma}(b),$$

Or without using j :

$$(a) \ r(ub) = (r(au) \bmod \sigma^{q-1}) \cdot \sigma + r_{\Sigma}(b),$$

and for the rising ranking function:

$$(b) \ r(zb) = \lfloor \frac{j}{\sigma} \rfloor + f(b), \quad \text{where } f(b) = r_{\Sigma}(b) \cdot \sigma^{q-1}.$$

Or without using j and f :

$$(b) \ r(zb) = \lfloor \frac{r(au)}{\sigma} \rfloor + r_{\Sigma}(b) \cdot \sigma^{q-1}.$$

If we take a more detailed look at both systems now, we can see that the second way is possibly more efficient (as it avoids the modulo operation and only uses integer division) if f is implemented as a lookup table $f : \Sigma \rightarrow \mathbb{N}_0$. If $\sigma = 2^k$ for some $k \in \mathbb{N}$, multiplications and divisions can be implemented by bit shifting operators, e.g. in the second system (b), $r(ub) = (j \gg k) + f(b)$.

It is allegedly easy to see that the q -gram corresponding to a ranking value can be obtained in $O(q)$ time for both unranking methods.

Now, to compute $d_q(x, y)$ for $x \in \Sigma^m$ and $y \in \Sigma^n$,

1. initialize integer array $p_q[0 \dots \sigma^q - 1]$ with zeroes
2. for each $i \in [1, mq + 1]$, increment $p_q[r(x[i \cdot i + q1])]$
3. for each $i \in [1, nq + 1]$, decrement $p_q[r(y[i \cdot i + q1])]$
4. initialize $d := 0$,
5. for each $j \in [0, \sigma^q - 1]$, increment d by $|p_q[j]|$

Comment 1.9 Explanation of the steps and complexites.

Step	Complexity	Because...
1. Initialise empty array	$O(\sigma^q)$	the array has σ^q entries
2. Count q -grams in x	$O(m)$	compute hash of first q -gram in $O(q)$, then use rolling hash to update in $O(1)$ for each remaining position
3. Count q -grams in y	$O(n)$	see above
4. Initialize distance	$O(1)$	trivial
5. Summarize the absolute difference	$O(\sigma^q)$	Iteration through σ^q items

Leading to:

$$O(\sigma^q) + O(m) + O(n) + O(\sigma^q) = 2 \cdot O(\sigma^q) + O(m) + O(n) = O(2 \cdot \sigma^q) + O(m) + O(n) = O(\sigma^q) + O(m) + O(n) = O(\sigma^q + m + n)$$

This procedure **very** obviously takes $O(\sigma^q + m + n)$ time. If $m \leq n$ and q is as suggested above $\left(q = \left\lceil \frac{\log(m) \log(c)}{\log(\sigma)} \right\rceil = \log(\sigma) \cdot \right.$, this is $O(n)$ time overall. The space complexity is $O(\sigma^q)$ to store the array p_q .

If q is comparatively large, it does not make sense to maintain a full array. Instead, we maintain a data structure that contains only the nonzero entries of p_q . If $q = O(\log(m + n))$, we can still achieve $O(m + n)$ time using hashing.

1.1.4 | Relation to the Edit Distance

While the q -gram distance d_q has its own applications in the comparison of sequences that have undergone block movements, it also has a weak connection to the unit cost edit distance d . Recall that we can have a high edit distance even though $d_q(x, y) = 0$. On the other hand, a single edit operation changes up to q q -grams. Generally, one can show the following relationship.

Theorem 1.2 Let d denote the standard unit cost edit distance. Then

$$\frac{d_q(x, y)}{2q} \leq d(x, y).$$

Proof. Each edit operation locally affects up to q q -grams. Each changed q -gram can cause a change of up to 2 in d_q , as the occurrence count of one q -gram decreases, the other increases. Therefore, each edit operation can lead to an increase of $2q$ of the q -gram distance in the worst case (e.g. consider AAAAAAAAAA vs. AABAABAABAA with edit distance 3, $q = 3$, and, as can be verified, $d_3 = 18$).

How this relationship can be used productively in order to speed up the computation of the edit distance will be discussed in Section 1.2.

[1]

Notiz

Warnung 1.1 Achtung:

- **Pseudometrik!** $d_q(s, t) = 0 \not\Rightarrow s = t$. Verschiedene Strings können dasselbe q-Gramm-Profil haben (z. B. Anagramme von q-Grammen). Nur eine Richtung der Metrik-Axiome gilt strikt.
- **rising vs. falling** innerhalb einer Aufgabe konsistent halten – sonst passen Rank und Un-Rank nicht zusammen.
- Rand: ein String mit $|s| < q$ hat keine q-Gramme.

1.2 | The Maximal Matches Distance

Another notion of distance that admits large block movements is the **maximal matches distance to x from y** . It is based on the idea that we can cover a sequence x with substrings of another sequence (and vice versa) that are interspersed with single characters.

Idea 1.2 Wie gut lässt sich s aus langen Stücken von t zusammensetzen? Wenige, lange “Matches” $\Rightarrow$ ähnlich; viele kurze $\Rightarrow$ unähnlich.

Greedy von links, jeweils der längste Teilstring, der in t vorkommt.

Partitioning a sequence. Consider a sequence $x = z_0 b_1 z_1 b_2 \dots z_{l-1} b_l z_l$, with $|x| = m$, such that each z_i is a (possibly empty) string (for $0 \leq i \leq l$) and each b_i is a single character (for $1 \leq i \leq l$). The tuple $P = (z_0, \langle b_1 \rangle, z_1, \langle b_2 \rangle, \dots, z_{l-1}, \langle b_l \rangle, z_l)$ is a partition of x with respect to another sequence y if each z_i is also a substring of y . The size of the partition P , denoted by $|P|$, is the number of its separating single characters, that is, $|P| = l$. Note that, if x is a substring of y , there exists the shortest partition $P_0 = (x)$, of size 0. In the other extreme, the longest partition $P_m = (\epsilon, \langle x[1] \rangle, \epsilon, \langle x[2] \rangle, \dots, \langle x[m] \rangle, \epsilon)$ of size m always exists, even if $y = \epsilon$.

Example 1.4 Let $x = CTAATGCT$ and $y = ATCTA$. The following sequences are partitions of x with respect to y : $P = (CTA, \langle A \rangle, T, \langle G \rangle, CT)$ with $|P| = 2$, $P' = (CTA, \langle A \rangle, T, \langle G \rangle, C, \langle T \rangle, \epsilon)$ with $|P'| = 3$ and $P'' = (CT, \langle A \rangle, AT, \langle G \rangle, CT)$ with $|P''| = 2$.

Definition 1.9 maximal matches distance to x from y $\delta(x||y) := \min\{|P| : P \text{ is a partition of } x \text{ with respect to } y\}$

1.2.1 | Efficient Computation

The next question is how to find a minimum size partition of x with respect to y among all the partitions. Fortunately, this turns out to be easy: A greedy strategy does the job. We start covering x at the first position by a match of maximal length k such that $z_0 := x[1 \dots k]$ is a substring of y , but $z_0 b_1 = x[1 \dots k+1]$ is not a substring of y . We apply the same strategy to the remainder of x , $x[k+2 \dots m]$.

Definition 1.10 left-to-right partition of x with respect to y $Plr(x, y) = (z_0, \langle b_1 \rangle, z_1, \langle b_2 \rangle, \dots, z_{\ell-1}, \langle b_\ell \rangle, z_\ell)$ of x with respect to y is the partition defined by the condition that for all $i \in [1, \ell]$, $z_{i-1} b_i$ is not a substring of y .

Comment 1.10 Sie wird so gewählt, dass für jedes $i \in [1, \ell]$ die Konkatenation $z_{i-1} b_i$ kein Teilstring von y ist. Also: Die Blöcke werden beim Durchlaufen von x von links nach rechts genau an den Stellen getrennt, an denen das Anhängen des nächsten Zeichens dazu führen würde, dass der aktuelle Teilstring nicht mehr in y vorkommt.

Definition 1.11 right-to-left partition of x with respect to y $P_{rl}(x, y) = (z_0, \langle b_1 \rangle, z_1, \dots, \langle b_{\ell_1} \rangle, z_{\ell_1}, \langle b_{\ell} \rangle, z_{\ell})$
of x with respect to y is the partition defined by the condition that for all $i \in [1, \ell]$, $b_i z_i$ is not a substring of y .

Comment 1.11 Die Partition wird so gewählt, dass für jedes $i \in [1, \ell]$ die Konkatenation $b_i z_i$ kein Teilstring von y ist.

Theorem 1.3 The left-to-right partition of x with respect to y is a partition of minimal length, i.e.,

$$|P_{LR}(x, y)| = \min\{|P| : P \text{ is a partition of } x \text{ with respect to } y\} = \delta(x||y).$$

The same is true for the right-to-left partition of x with respect to y , which means:

$$|P_{RL}(x, y)| = |P_{LR}(x, y)| = \delta(x||y).$$

Proof. Skript S. 7

It is important to discuss how (and how fast) we can compute the size of a left-to-right partition. In fact, because the longest common substring z that starts at a given position i in x and occurs somewhere in y can easily be found in $O(|z|)$ time using the suffix tree of y , we obtain the following result.

Theorem 1.4 The maximal matches distance $\delta(x||y)$ to a sequence x from another sequence y can be computed in $O(|x| + |y|)$ time.

Proof. Skript S. 8

1.2.2 | Relation to the Edit Distance

Like the q-gram distance, also the maximal matches distance can be used to compute a lower bound of the edit distance.

Theorem 1.5 Let $d(x, y)$ be the unit cost edit distance between sequences x and y . Then $\delta(x||y) \leq d(x, y)$.

Proof. Skript S. 8

Again, this bound permits us to speed up the computation of the edit distance, as will be shown in Section 1.2.3.

1.2.3 | Maximal Matches Metric

A final observation is that δ is obviously not symmetric: $\delta(x||y) = 0$ is equivalent to x being a substring of y . Therefore, the maximal matches distance is not a metric and the name distance is misleading. But it is possible to use δ for designing an appropriate symmetric function that satisfies the triangular inequality and is a metric.

Theorem 1.6 Given sequences x and y from Σ^* , let the function $d_{||}(x, y)$ defined as $d_{||}(x, y) = \log(\delta(x||y) + 1) + \log(\delta(y||x) + 1)$. Then $d_{||}(x, y)$ is a metric on Σ^* .

Proof. Skript S. 8

Warnung 1.2 Achtung: Die Distanz ist **asymmetrisch** definiert (s zerlegt bzgl. t), je nach genauer Skript-Definition wird noch symmetrisiert / mit einem Term normiert. Nach Preprocessing von t läuft die Zerlegung von s in $O(|s|)$. Es ist eine **untere Schranke**-Heuristik für die Editdistanz, keine exakte Distanz.

1.3 | Filtration for Edit Distance

Coming back to the **edit distance**, while – given the fact that the search space (consisting of all pairwise alignments of x and y) is of exponential size – the quadratic time dynamic programming solution can be considered very efficient, it can also be considered quite slow in practice when the sequences are long. Moreover, the quadratic space requirements (unless a space-saving technique is used that we will discuss in Chapter 6) can cause even larger problems.

Now, remember that in many applications the goal of sequence comparison is not the construction of an accurate alignment. Instead, for example in a database search context, one is mostly interested in identifying sequences similar to a given query. More formally:

Problem 1.2 Given a database $X = x_1, x_2, \dots, x_k$ of k sequences $x_i \in \Sigma^*$, a query sequence $y \in \Sigma^*$ and a distance threshold $t \geq 0$, find all sequences $x \in X$ such that $d(x, y) \leq t$.

Clearly, a straightforward way to solve this problem is to compare y to each sequence $x \in X$, one after the other. Whenever in such a comparison the distance $d(x, y)$ is smaller or equal to the threshold t , then the sequence x is reported, otherwise it is discarded. This strategy clearly takes $O(k \cdot mn)$ time, where m is an upper bound for the database sequence length and $n = |y|$.

However, since usually t is small and many sequences in x will be quite dissimilar from y , it may be possible to quickly screen the database and separate interesting candidates from irrelevant sequences, faster than computing the **edit distance** for all of them. If such a screening procedure guarantees that all relevant sequences $x \in X$ with $d(x, y) \leq t$ are among the remaining candidates, it is called a filter. Generally, we thus have a two-step procedure. First, in a fast filtration step, candidates are identified that have a chance to be hits. Then, in a verification step these candidates are checked with the (usually slower) exact method whether they really qualify as hits. Obviously, filtration makes sense only if the procedure employed in the filtration step has a lower time complexity than the procedure used in the verification step. Indeed, if one has multiple filters, one can first apply all of them, and then employ the verification only to those elements $x \in X$ that pass all the filters. In the previous sections we have seen two fast sequence comparison methods that can be used as filters for the unit cost **edit distance**. Both of them require only time proportional to the sum of the lengths of the two sequences (“linear time”) and provide lower bounds for the **edit distance**.

Filtration with the q-gram distance. The property outlined in Theorem 1.2 can be used as a filter criterion for the **edit distance**: For a given query sequence y and **edit distance** threshold t , and a given value of q , a database sequence $x \in X$ can be discarded whenever $d_q(x, y)/(2q) > t$. In case of a global similarity of the sequences and the differences spread out evenly, this filter will work quite well. If the difference between the two sequences, however, is by block movements, then the **edit distance** is usually very high, although the **q-gram distance** may still be low and produce a false positive candidate when used as a filter.

Filtration with the maximal matches distance. As shown in Theorem 1.5, the maximal matches distance also gives us a bound for the unit cost **edit distance**. In fact, since the **edit distance** is symmetric, the filtration can even be used twice, once with $d(x||y)$ and once with $d(y||x)$. This results in the following filter: For a given query sequence y and edit distance threshold t , a database sequence $x \in X$ can be discarded whenever $\delta(x||y) > t$ or $\delta(y||x) > t$.

Note that the distinguishing feature of a filter is that it never discards a hit (has no false negatives). On the other hand, one can also develop heuristics that approximate the edit distance and are efficiently computable. Good heuristics (like BLAST) will be close to the true result with high probability; hence the error made by using them is small most of the time. There is no guarantee, though, that a true hit will not be missed. [1]

Practical Aspects of de Bruijn Graphs

A note on terminology: In Section 1.1 we were speaking of *q*-grams when referring to short (sub)strings of a certain length q . This notation has originally been introduced in the computer science literature and is there in use until today. An alternative, equivalent notion that one finds in most of the biologicalⁱ and bioinformatics literature, is that of a k -mer. Here k refers to the (sub)string length. To be more consistent with the literature, in this chapter we will adopt that notation.

2.1 | Definition and Basic Properties

Remember the following definition, where $s_{k,i} := s[i \dots i+k-1]$ denotes the k -mer starting at index i , $1 \leq i \leq |s|-k+1$:

Definition 2.1 de Bruijn subgraph $DBG(s, k) = (V, E)$ for a given sequence s of dimension k () The de Bruijn subgraph $DBG(s, k) = (V, E)$ for a given sequence s of dimension k (positive integer $\leq |s|$) is a directed multigraph whose vertices V correspond to the distinct k -mers of s , $s_{k,1}, \dots, s_{k,|s|-k+1}$, and whose edges are derived from the $(k+1)$ -mers of s as follows: Let a $(k+1)$ -mer of s be denoted as $s[i \dots i+k] = aub$, where a and b are symbols and $|u| = k-1$, then a directed edge is contained in E , linking vertex au to vertex ub .

Definition 2.2 Dimension of a de Bruijn subgraph $DBG(s, k) = (V, E)$ for a given sequence s of dimension k () The positive integer $\leq |s|$ in a $DBG(s, k) = (V, E)$.

Note 2.1 To 2.1 If the same $(k+1)$ -mer occurs multiple times in s , say m times, we have m parallel edges occurring in the multigraph $DBG(s, k)$.

Comment 2.1 Für jeden DB Graph gibt es immer einen Eulerpfad

2.2 | Words with the same $(k+1)$ -mer Profile

Motivated by the fact that the *q*-gram distance does not satisfy the identity property of a metric (see Section 1.1) because there can be distinct sequences with the same *q*-gram profile, we want to determine whether for a given sequence s and integer k there are other sequences that are distinct but have the same $(k+1)$ -mer profile as s . And, if there are, how many?

ⁱThe true origin is probably in biochemistry, where notions like monomer or polymer refer to molecular chains of certain lengths.

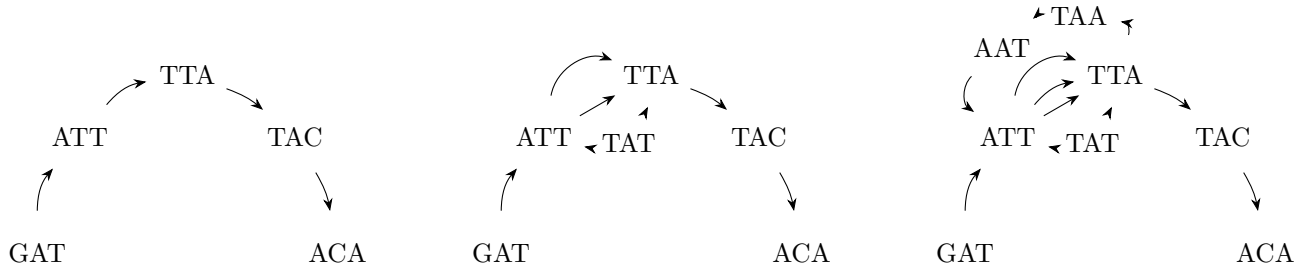
For $k = 0$, the problem is trivial. Indeed, if a sequence t that is distinct from s corresponds to a permutation of the symbols of s , then s and t clearly share the same 1-mer profile. For $k \geq 1$, an elegant answer can be found with the help of the **de Bruijn subgraph** $DBG(s, k)$.

Clearly, by construction $DBG(s, k)$ forms an Eulerian path p_s , represented by its sequence of vertices

$$s_{k,1}, s_{k,2}, \dots, s_{k,|s|-k+1}.$$

Consequently, $DBG(s, k)$ is connected and balanced and might contain even more than one Eulerian path. In fact, there is a one-to-one correspondence between Eulerian paths in $DBG(s, k)$ and sequences sharing the same $(k + 1)$ -mer profile. In other words, a sequence t that is distinct but has the same $(k + 1)$ -mer profile as s exists if and only if $DBG(s, k)$ has another Eulerian path p_t corresponding to the sequence of $(k + 1)$ -mers of t . Since p_t uses the same edges as p_s in a different order, the path p_t can only exist if $DBG(s, k)$ contains a cycle. Note, however, that the presence of a cycle is not a sufficient condition. Indeed, it is possible that $DBG(s, k)$ contains one or more cycles, but still admits only one Eulerian path. Some examples are given in Figures 2.1 and

Example 2.1



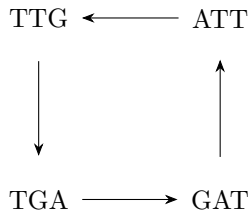
(a) $x = GATTACA, k=3$ - Since this graph contains no cycle, it has only one Eulerian path. There can be no other word sharing the same 4-mer profile.

(b) $x = GATTATTACA, k=3$ - Here the graph contains two cycles, but still only one Eulerian path. There is no other word sharing the same 4-mer profile.

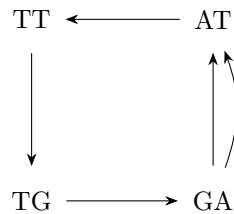
(c) $x = GATTATTAATTACA, k=3$ - This graph contains several cycles and two distinct Eulerian paths. There is exactly one other word with the same 4-mer profile, GATTAATTATTACA.

Figure 2.1: Examples of **de Bruijn subgraphs** for distinct sequences and $k=3$.

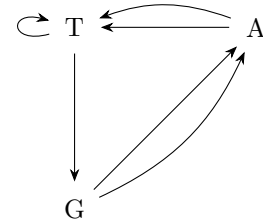
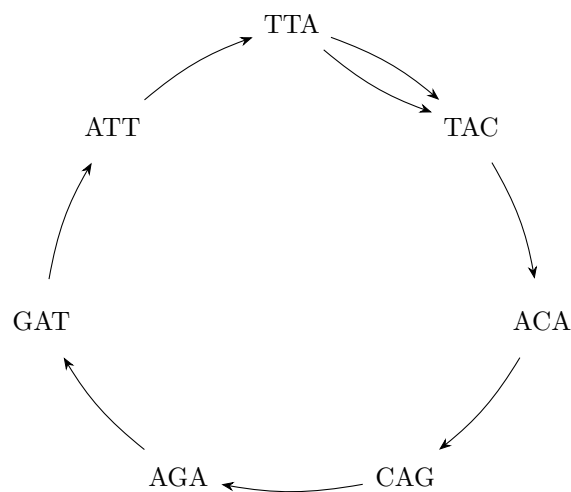
Example 2.2

$x = \text{GATTGAT}$ and $k = 3$ 

(a)

 $x = \text{GATTGAT}$ and $k = 2$ 

(b)

 $x = \text{GATTGAT}$ and $k = 1$ **Figure 2.2:** De Bruijn subgraphs for the same sequence but with k varying from 3 to 1.**Example 2.3** Additional example from lecture**Figure 2.3:** It could also be on big circle.**Comment 2.2** Reminder that the edges are basically this:

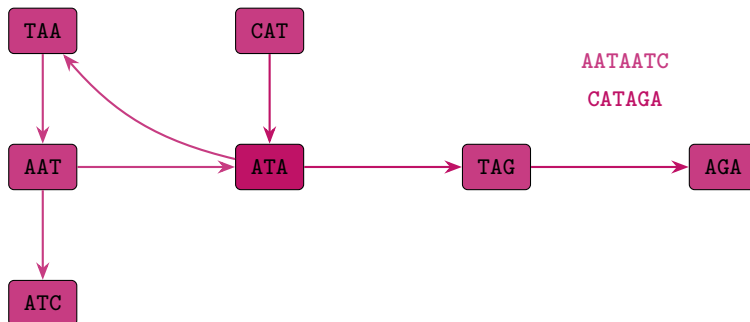
Comment 2.3 To figure 2.1 man könnte bei fig 2.1a denken hey bei a kann es nur einen EP geben, weil es kein Kreis ist, und bei 2.1b muss es dann mehrere geben, weil da eine Schleife drin ist, aber NEIN der Pfad ist die Reihenfolge der Knoten und nicht der Kanten, also gibt es nur einen. Man kann nicht unterscheiden, ob man zuerst die obere oder untere Kante der Schleife zuerst gegangen ist. Gibt also nur eine sequenz mit em $k+1$ meer profil. Denn die Sequenz wird ja *aus* den Knoten gemacht, nicht den Kanten ...sozusagen.

We summarize the observations above in the following theorem.

Theorem 2.1 Given a sequence s and an integer $k \geq 1$, the number of distinct sequences that have the same $(k+1)$ -mer profile as s equals the number of distinct Eulerian paths in $DBG(s, k)$. If $DBG(s, k)$ is acyclic, it has a single Eulerian path, and no sequence t exists that is distinct but has the same $(k+1)$ -mer profile as s .

Comment 2.4 Auf deutsch: # worte mit gleichen $(k+1)$ -mer Profil wie s = # Euler-Pfade in $DBG(s, k)$

Example 2.4 Beispiel von Blatt 8 AATAATC: 3-Mere AAT, ATA, TAA, AAT, ATC $\Rightarrow$ Kanten AAT $\rightarrow$ ATA $\rightarrow$ TAA $\rightarrow$ AAT $\rightarrow$ ATC.
CATAGA: 3-Mere CAT, ATA, TAG, AGA $\Rightarrow$ Kanten CAT $\rightarrow$ ATA $\rightarrow$ TAG $\rightarrow$ AGA. Gemeinsamer Knoten: ATA.



Warnung 2.1 Achtung:

- **Konvention prüfen!** Andere Bücher setzen Knoten = $(k-1)$ -Mere, Kanten = k -Mere. Hier gilt: Knoten = k -Mere, Kanten = $(k+1)$ -Mere. Immer die Vorlesungs-Konvention nutzen.
- Kanten sind ein **Multiset** (mehrfaches Vorkommen zählt), wenn es um Euler-Pfade/Assembly geht.
- k -Mere ranken/un-ranken = dasselbe Schema wie q -Gramme (Kap. 1.1). Speicherung als Set von k -Meren (Kap. 2.4).

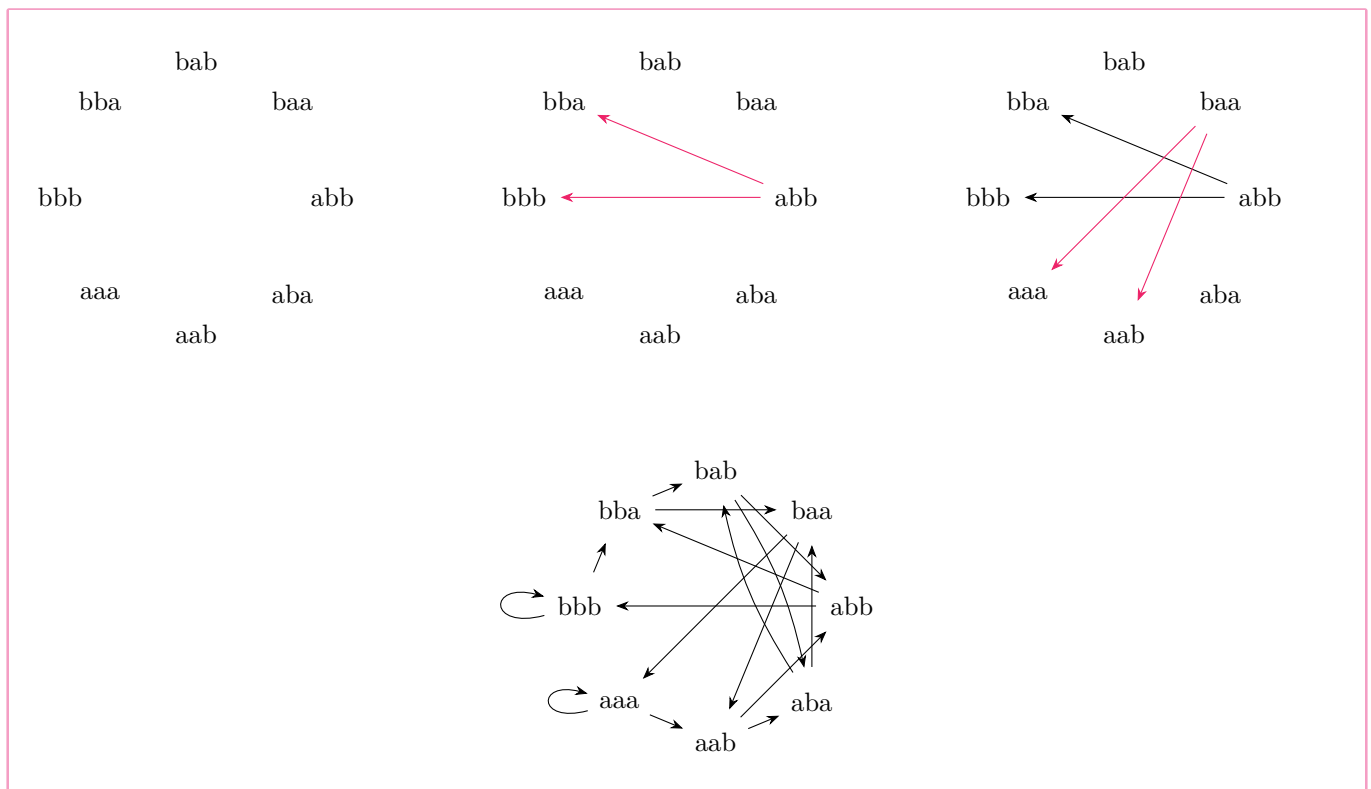
2.3 | Variants of de Bruijn Graphs

Comment 2.5 Der Begriff *dbg* ist sehr dehnbar, es ist in der Literatur nicht immer das gleiche damit gemeint. Viele sagen *dbg*, wenn sie eigentlich *dbsg* meinen.

Although, strictly speaking, we consider most of the time **de Bruijn subgraphs** (for a given sequence), often they are just called de Bruijn graphs. In fact, there are more variants of de Bruijn graphs, and often they are also not named very carefully. Here we will discuss them and introduce a precise nomenclature.

Definition 2.3 original de Bruijn graph of dimension k over a finite alphabet Σ of size σ The graph that contains one vertex for each k -mer (and therefore σ^k vertices) and a directed edge for each overlap of length $k-1$ (and therefore σ^{k+1} edges)

Example 2.5 for original de Bruijn graph



The **de Bruijn subgraph** for a given sequence s of dimension k is the one that we introduced in Definition 2.1. It has several interesting properties (see Section 2.1) and is used in various contexts in bioinformatics like genome assembly and pangenomics.

Problem 2.1 In most bioinformatics applications where DNA sequence reads come from a sequencing machine, it is not clear from which strand of the DNA double helix a read originates.

GATT → ATTA → TTAC → TACA

GCTG → CTGT → TGTA

Therefore, one prefers to identify a k -mer z with its reverse complement $z^{\leftarrow 1}$ and represent them by the same vertex in the graph:

Example 2.6 reverse complement

GATT → ATTA → TTAC → TACA / TGTA

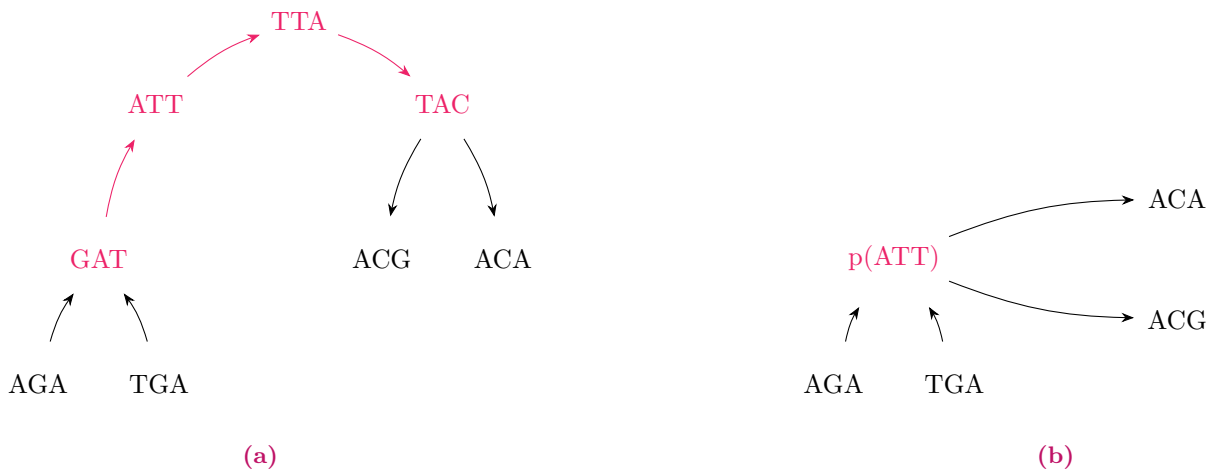
GCTG → CTGT → TGTA

Definition 2.4 Bidirected de Bruijn subgraph Erweitert den klassischen de-Bruijn-Graphen, indem jedes k -Mer mit seinem Reverse-Komplement identifiziert wird. Beide Sequenzen werden somit durch denselben Knoten repräsentiert. Diese Darstellung berücksichtigt, dass bei DNA-Sequenzierungen häufig nicht bekannt ist, von welchem Strang der DNA-Doppelhelix ein Read stammt. Die übrige Struktur des de-Bruijn-Graphen, insbesondere die Definition der Kanten, bleibt unverändert..

Finally, in a (bidirected) **de Bruijn subgraph** one often finds stretches of vertices that have only one successor, the next k -mer in the originating sequence(s). Such a non-branching path can be collapsed into a single vertex (representing a k' -mer for some $k' \geq k$), called *unitig*, saving space and often computation time.

Definition 2.5 Compacted de Bruijn subgraph Entsteht durch das Zusammenfassen nicht verzweigender Pfade eines de-Bruijn-Graphen. Besitzt eine Folge aufeinanderfolgender Knoten jeweils genau einen Nachfolger und einen Vorgänger (mit Ausnahme der Endknoten), so wird diese zu einem einzelnen Knoten, einem sogenannten *Unitig*, zusammengefasst. Dieser repräsentiert ein längeres Teilstück der ursprünglichen Sequenz. Durch diese Kompaktierung werden Speicherbedarf und häufig auch die Laufzeit nachfolgender Algorithmen reduziert, ohne dass die wesentliche Struktur des Graphen verloren geht..

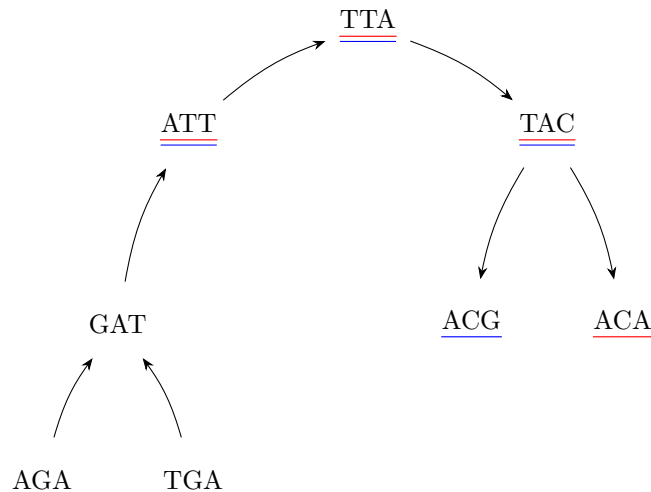
Example 2.7 for compacted de Bruijn subgraph



An additional variant comes into play when the input sequences are partitioned into several groups, for example representing different genomes, and these groups shall also be distinguished in the de Bruijn graph. Then one assigns a color (usually a single bit indicating presence or absence) to each group. A k -mer inherits this color, so that each k -mer gets assigned a color set, indicating in which groups it appears and in which not.

Definition 2.6 Colored de Bruijn subgraph Erweitert den de-Bruijn-Graphen um Informationen über die Herkunft der k -Mere. Hierzu werden die Eingabesequenzen in mehrere Gruppen, beispielsweise verschiedene Genome oder Datensätze, unterteilt. Jeder Gruppe wird eine Farbe zugewiesen. Ein Knoten erhält die Menge aller Farben der Gruppen, in denen das entsprechende k -Mer vorkommt. Dadurch lässt sich nachvollziehen, in welchen Sequenzmengen ein k -Mer enthalten ist. Colored de-Bruijn-Graphen eignen sich insbesondere für den Vergleich mehrerer Genome, erfordern jedoch aufgrund der Speicherung der Farbinformationen deutlich mehr Speicher als klassische de-Bruijn-Graphen..

Example 2.8 for colored de Bruijn subgraph



Problem 2.2 Colored de Bruijn subgraphs form a very powerful data structure, but their memory-efficient implementation is not trivial. In fact, the main challenge is no longer the storage of the k -mers (whose number is limited by σ^k , see above), but the storage of the colors, which may occupy several thousand bits per k -mer in case of large pangenomes.

log der alphabetgröße zur basis 2 ist wie viele bits man braucht zum codieren $k \cdot 2$ bits für dbg, aber mit Farben muss man ja noch bits dran hängen, das ist groß und noch ungelöst, denn es ist dann $k \cdot 2 + \#$ datensätze

Example 2.9 bsp zu bits acg codiert als 000110 wenn

A	0	0
C	0	1
G	1	0
T	1	1

2.4 | Implementation of de Bruijn Graphs: Sets of k -mers

Here we consider only the basic variant of de Bruijn subgraphs. With a little bit of effort all results can also be generalized to the other graph types.

A simple observation allows to save considerable space: Assume we have a very fast method to test if a certain k -mer is represented in de Bruijn graph $G = \text{DBG}(s, k)$ or not. Then one does not need to store the edges explicitly, for the following reason. When traversing from a vertex representing k -mer au to an adjacent vertex representing k -mer ub ($a, b \in \Sigma, u \in \Sigma^{k-1}$), instead of following the edge $au \rightarrow ub$ explicitly (if it exists), we can instead just test if ub is represented as a vertex in G or not. If the test is successful, we know that the edge exists and therefore can be traversed. If the test is unsuccessful, then the edge does not exist and can not be traversed. Similarly, if we want to find all possible successors of the vertex representing k -mer au , we perform σ tests, one for each possible last character c of the new, overlapping k -mer uc . Especially for small alphabets like DNA, this is not very much work.

Therefore, in (DNA-) bioinformatics applications, a data structure is very popular that represents only a set S of k -mers and offers a very quick presence/absence test, instead of storing a complete graph data structure: the Bloom filter.

The idea is to use one large bit array B of length m , say, as a hash table with all bits initially set to *false* (F), and then have a small number of h different hash functions $f_1, f_2, \dots, f_h$ that map k -mers (respectively, their ranks) to integers in the range $[0, m-1]$. In order to store a k -mer (respectively its rank r), the hash functions are computed

and the corresponding bits in B are set:

$$B[f_1(r)] = B[f_2(r)] = \dots = B[f_h(r)] = T.$$

This is repeated for each k -mer.

As always, the hash functions should be independent and uniformly distributed. A very simple one is of the form $f_i(r) = (r^{i+1} \gg k) \bmod m$, where $\gg k$ denotes k -fold bitwise right-shift. There exist, however, much more advanced hash functions in the literature.

In order to test whether a k -mer with rank r has been stored in a Bloom filter B , we perform the same procedure: We evaluate all hash functions in parallel, and if all of them point to T entries in the hash table, then it is very likely that the element r has been stored in B :

$$\text{probably-contains}(B, r) = B[f_1(r)] \wedge B[f_2(r)] \wedge \dots \wedge B[f_h(r)],$$

where $\wedge$ denotes logical AND.

By the combination of several distinct hash functions, a k -mer z (with $\text{rank } r = \text{rank}(z)$) will be reported as a false positive, although it has not been stored in the Bloom filter, only if all hash functions are involved in collisions, i.e., if for each of the h hash values $f_i(r)$, $1 \leq i \leq h$, some other k -mer $z' \neq z$ produces with some hash function f_i the same hash value ($f_i(\text{rank}(z')) = f_i(r)$) and therefore sets B at this position to T . While this is quite unlikely in practice as long as the hash table is only moderately filled, it can not be completely avoided. Therefore the above function is called “probably-contains” and not “contains”. There are some techniques to handle false positives in certain applications manually, so that they do not distort the result and the Bloom filter becomes exact. [1]

Approximative String Matching

Comment 3.1 “In computer science, approximate string matching (often colloquially referred to as fuzzy string searching) is the technique of finding strings that match a pattern approximately (rather than exactly). The problem of approximate string matching is typically divided into two sub-problems: finding approximate substring matches inside a given string and finding dictionary strings that match the pattern approximately.” - [2]

Idea 3.1 Semi-globales Alignment: Finde alle Endpositionen j im Text y , an denen das Muster x mit Editdistanz $\leq k$ endet. Trick: 0. Zeile = 0 (Muster darf überall im Text starten), letzte Zeile $\leq k \Rightarrow$ Treffer (Darf überall im text enden).

In the “Sequence Analysis 1” class, we have already discussed a variant of the Universal Alignment Algorithm that can be used to find a best (highest score) alignment of a (short) pattern x within a (long) text y : semi-global alignment. Often, we are interested in all matches with at least a certain score. A simple modification makes this possible: We just need to visit all predecessors of the final cell v_E and check whether the corresponding solutions fulfill the given criterion. (In the case of semi-global alignment, these cells correspond to the last row of the alignment matrix.)

In this section, we consider the cost-based formulation and therefore alignment matrix D . We assume that a sensible cost function $\text{cost}: \mathcal{A} \rightarrow \mathbb{R}_0^+$ for alignment columns is given where $\text{cost}(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ a \end{pmatrix}) = 0$, $\text{cost}(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ b \end{pmatrix}) > 0$ for $a \neq b$ and all indels have the same cost $\gamma > 0$.

Then we consider the following problem variant:

Definition 3.1 Approximate string matching problem todo.

In fact, it suffices to discover the ending positions j of the substrings y' because we can always reconstruct the whole substring and its starting position by backtracing.

Definition 3.2 k-approximate matches of x in y $i^*(C) := \max\{i \mid C(i) \leq k\}$

3.1 | Sellers' Algorithm

For a change in style, here we present an explicit formulation of an algorithm that solves the problem not as a recurrence, but in pseudo-code notation. Algorithm 1 is known as Sellers' algorithm (Sellers, 1980). Of course, it corresponds to the Universal Alignment Algorithm variant discussed in the “Sequence Analysis 1” class for semi-global alignment, except that we do not look at the final vertex v_E to find the best match, but look at all the vertices in the last row to identify all matches with $D(m, j) \leq k$ for $0 \leq j \leq n$.

Looking closely at Algorithm ??, we see that each iteration $j = 1, \dots, n$ transforms the previous column $C_{j-1} := D(\cdot, j-1)$ of the edit matrix into the current column $C_j := D(\cdot, j)$, based on character $y[j]$. Starting with C_0 ,

Sellers' algorithm effectively consists of repeatedly computing C_j from C_{j-1} and the next text character $y[j]$, for each $j = 1, \dots, n$.

Input: pattern $x \in \Sigma^m$, text $y \in \Sigma^n$, threshold $k \in \mathbb{N}_0$, sensible cost function with indel cost $\gamma > 0$, defining an edit distance $d(\cdot, \cdot)$
Output: ending positions j such that $d(x, y') \leq k$ where $y' := y[j' \dots j]$ for some $j' \leq j$
// initialize the 0-th column of the alignment matrix
for $i \leftarrow 0, \dots, m$ **do**
 $C_0(i) \leftarrow i \cdot \gamma$
end for
// proceed column-by-column
for $j \leftarrow 1, \dots, n$ **do**
 $C_j(0) \leftarrow 0$
 for $i \leftarrow 1, \dots, m$ **do**
 $C_j(i) \leftarrow \min \begin{cases} C_{j-1}(i-1) + \text{cost}(x[i], y[j]) \\ C_{j-1}(i) + \gamma \\ C_j(i-1) + \gamma \end{cases}$
 end for
 if $C_j(m) \leq k$ **then**
 // report match ending at column j and its cost
 report $(j, C_j(m))$
 end if
end for

Comment 3.2 Hier ist: Zeilen = pattern und Spalten = text. Nicht wundern, einige Erklärungen machen das andersherum.

Comment 3.3 Die erste Spalte ("0-th column of the alignment matrix") beinhaltet sozusagen die Kosten den Text des patterns bis zu der Stelle an einen leeren Text anzupassen.

"pattern"	Kosten
ϵ	0
A	1
AC	2
ACG	3
$ACGT$	4

Deswegen ja auch $C_0(i) \leftarrow i \cdot \gamma$, also $C_0(i) = i \cdot \gamma$. Denn γ ist die Kost für ein Indel und wenn man i viele Zeichen löschen will, muss man eben i -oft mal γ bezahlen.

Comment 3.4 Wichtiger Unterschied zu anderen Algorithmen: Das Pattern darf an jeder beliebigen Position im Text beginnen! Deswegen ist die erste Zeile eine Nullzeile...sozusagen. Dann kann man mit Null Kosten jederzeit einsteigen und muss nicht für das Überspringen etwas bezahlen.

Betrachtet man $TTACG$ und ACG , dann würde man bspw. bei Wagner-Fischer berechnen

$$d(ACG, TTACG) = 2$$

und bei Sellers würde man berechnen

$$d(ACG, ACG) = 0,$$

weil man das " TT " einfach überspringen kann.

Das liegt auch daran, dass Sellers eine andere Fragestellung als Wagner-Fischer verfolgt. Sellers will kein komplettes Alignment finden, nur ein ungefähres.

Deswegen darf es auch irgendwo im Text enden und man muss die ganze letzte Zeile betrachten (und schauen wo der höchste Wert ist) anstatt nur ganz rechts unten.

Since we only report end positions and costs, there is no need to store back pointers and the entire alignment matrix D in Algorithm ???. The current and the previous column suffice. This decreases the space requirement to $O(m)$, where m is the (short) pattern length. We still need to store the text, which is $O(n)$, however this need not necessarily be in memory.

If we have a very good match with cost $< k$ at position j , the neighboring positions will also match with cost $\leq k$. To avoid this redundancy, it makes sense to post-process the output and only look for runs of local minima. Without formally defining it, if $k = 3$ and the respective costs at positions $j - 2, \dots, j + 4$ are $(3, 2, 1, 1, 2, 2, 3)$, the original algorithm will report all of these positions. In most applications, however, we are only interested in the locally minimal value 1, which occurs as a run of length 2. So it would make sense to report the run interval and the minimum cost as $([j, j + 1], 1)$.

Note 3.1 Note that at no time in the algorithm we need to know the exact value of $C_j(m)$ as long as we can be sure that it exceeds k and therefore will not be reported.

3.2 | Ukkonen's Cutoff Algorithm

The last of the above three observations leads to a considerable improvement of Sellers' algorithm: If we know that in column j all values after a certain index i_j^* exceed k , we do not need to compute them (e.g. we could assume that they are all equal to ∞ or $k + 1$). The following definition captures this formally.

Definition 3.3 last essential index i^* (for threshold k) of a column C todo

The last essential index i_j^* of column C_j is $i_j^* := i^*(C_j) = \max\{i | C_j(i) \leq k\}$. From the definition it is clear that we cannot miss any k -approximate matches if we do not compute the cells below the last essential index.

To set this in operation, the last essential index i_0^* of the 0-th column is easily found, because the scores increase monotonically from 0 to $m \cdot \gamma$. The other columns, however, are not necessarily monotone! Therefore, as we move column-by-column through the matrix, we have to make sure that we can efficiently find the last essential index of the next column, given the previous column. Consider the effects of the C_{j-1} -entries below the last essential index on the next column C_j . Since $C_{j-1}(i) > k$ for all $i > i_{j-1}^* - 1$ and costs are non-negative, these cells provide candidate values $> k$ for $C_j(i)$ for $i > i_{j-1}^* + 1$ which therefore do not need to be considered during the minimization. The only chance that such $C_j(i)$ remain bounded by k is vertically, i.e., if $C_j(i) = C_j(i - 1) + \gamma$. As soon as $C_j(i) > k$ for some $i > i_{j-1}^* + 1$, we know that the last essential index i_j^* of C_j occurs before that i . Algorithm 1 shows the details.

Example 3.1 Let $x = \text{AABB}$, $y = \text{BABAABAABBABAA}$ and $k = 1$. The following table shows which values are computed by Algorithm 2 considering unit cost. The last essential index in each column is encircled. The k -approximate matches are underlined in the last row.

$x \backslash y$	ϵ	B	A	B	A	A	B	A	A	B	B	A	B	A	A
$i = 0$	ϵ	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0	0
$i = 1$	A	1	1	0	1	0	0	1	0	0	1	1	0	1	0
$i = 2$	A		2	1	1	1	0	1	1	0	1	2	1	1	0
$i = 3$	B				1	2	1	0	1	1	0	1	2	1	2
$i = 4$	B							2	1	1	2	1	0	1	2
					I	II		III		IV		V			

Five exemplary alignments are shown below, one for each of the underlined positions.

I	II	III	IV	V
AABB	AABB	AABB	AABB	AABB-
AAB-	AABA	AAB-	AABB	AABBA

Sometimes, because it was first published by Ukkonen (1985), this algorithm is referred to as Ukkonen's cutoff algorithm, although it is more common to use this name if the cost function is standard unit cost. In that case, even further optimizations are possible, but we do not discuss the details here.

3.3 | Search Schemes and Bidirectional Indices

Assume we want to do approximate string matching with a text index, as a generalization of exact string matching that can be very efficiently solved with suffix trees, suffix arrays or the Burrows-Wheeler Transform (BWT), as we have seen. In principle one can use these data structures also for approximate matching, if the solution space of pattern alignments with all candidate substrings of the text is enumerated by backtracking. However, if this is done in a straight left-to-right (as with suffix trees) or right-to-left (as with the BWT) organization, it will be very inefficient already for small error threshold k . A better way is the use of *search schemes* in combination with more flexible *bidirectional indices* that we will study in this section.

The general idea is that the pattern x is divided into several non-overlapping parts $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_p$. The search scheme (Kucherov et al., 2016) then formally consists of multiple searches, where a search is represented by the triple $S = (\pi, L, U)$. The permutation π of $\{1, 2, \dots, p\}$ specifies the order in which the parts of the pattern are matched. L and U are arrays of size p such that $L[i]$ and $U[i]$ denote lower and upper bounds of the number of errors after the first i parts are matched (in the order specified by π).

Definition 3.4 Pigeonhole principle search scheme Zerlegt das Muster x bei Fehlerschwelle k in $p = k + 1$ Teile $x_1, \dots, x_{k+1}$. Da bei $\leq k$ Fehlern mindestens ein Teil exakt vorkommen muss, besteht das Schema aus $k + 1$ Suchen S_i : Teil x_i exakt matchen, dann Backtracking nach links und rechts bis insgesamt k Fehler erreicht sind.

Pigeonhole search scheme. A simple and very natural search scheme is the following: For error threshold k , split the pattern x in $p = k + 1$ parts $x_1, x_2, \dots, x_{k+1}$, usually of roughly the same length. Clearly, if the whole pattern occurs in the text with at most k errors, then at least one of the parts must match exactly in the corresponding text region. Therefore, the search scheme consists of $k + 1$ searches $S_1, S_2, \dots, S_{k+1}$ where search S_i first matches pattern part x_i exactly, followed by a backtracking search to the left $(x_{i-1}, x_{i-2}, \dots, x_1)$ with not more than k errors, and finally a backtracking search to the right $(x_{i+1}, x_{i+2}, \dots, x_{k+1})$, with additional errors, until a total of k is reached (or the pattern is exhausted).

Example 3.2 Formally, for $k = 4$ the pigeonhole principle search scheme $S = (S_1, \dots, S_5)$ looks as follows:

$$\begin{aligned}
 S_1 &= (12345, 00000, 04444) \\
 S_2 &= (21345, 00000, 04444) \\
 S_3 &= (32145, 00000, 04444) \\
 S_4 &= (43215, 00000, 04444) \\
 S_5 &= (54321, 00000, 04444)
 \end{aligned}$$

Note that there may be redundant results that need to be filtered in a postprocessing step, for example if more than one pattern part occurs in one match with no errors.

Definition 3.5 MinU search scheme Search Scheme (Renders et al., 2024), dessen Fehlerbereiche $(L[i], U[i])$ langsamer wachsen als beim pigeonhole-Schema und das daher effizienter ist. Es ist *lossless*, d. h. kein Match mit bis zu k Fehlern wird verpasst (alle Fehlerkonfigurationen $(e_1, \dots, e_p)$ mit $\sum e_i \leq k$ sind abgedeckt)

MinU search scheme. Another example is the MinU search scheme (Renders et al., 2024). Its definition for $k = 4$ is as follows:

$$S_1 = (12345, 00222, 02244)$$

$$S_2 = (23145, 00000, 01244)$$

$$S_3 = (32145, 01111, 01244)$$

$$S_4 = (45321, 00003, 01444)$$

$$S_5 = (54321, 01114, 01444)$$

It is easy to see that MinU is more efficient, since the ranges $(L[i], U[i])$ grow slower than for the pigeonhole scheme. The main question is, though, whether it is *lossless*, i.e., no approximate match with up to k errors will be missed. This can be proven by showing that all possible error configurations $(e_1, e_2, \dots, e_p)$ are covered, where e_i is the number of errors in part x_i and $e_1 + e_2 + \dots + e_p \leq k$. This has been shown for the MinU scheme, although we will not go into details here.

Definition 3.6 bidirectional text indices Textindizes, die einen partiellen Match flexibel *sowohl nach links als auch nach rechts* verlängern können, wie es Search Schemes erfordern. Beispiele: Affix-Bäume/-Arrays, bidirektionale BWT, bidirektionaler Wavelet-Index, br-index, bidirektionaler Move-Index

Bidirectional indices. In order to combine search schemes with a text index, it is necessary that the search can be organized more flexibly than just left-to-right or just right-to-left. To this end, bidirectional text indices are very useful. They allow for extending a partial match either to the left or to the right, just as the search scheme requires. Several bidirectional indices have been developed over time, starting with affix trees (Stoye, 1995, 2000; Maaß, 2003) and affix arrays (Strothmann, 2007), followed by the bidirectional BWT (Lam et al., 2009), the bidirectional wavelet index (Schnattinger et al., 2012), the br-index (Arakawa et al., 2022) and finally the bidirectional move index (Depuydt et al., 2025). Details go beyond the scope of these lecture notes.

Algorithm 1 Ukkonen's algorithm

Input: Pattern $x \in \Sigma^m$, Text $y \in \Sigma^n$, Schwellenwert $k \in \mathbb{N}_0$, Kostenfunktion mit Indel-Kosten $\gamma > 0$

Output: Endpositionen j mit $d(x, y') \leq k$, wobei $y' = y[j' \dots j]$ für ein $j' \leq j$

▷ Initialize the 0-th column of the alignment matrix

$i_0^* \leftarrow \min\{m, \lfloor k/\gamma \rfloor\}$

for $i \leftarrow 0$ **to** i_0^* **do**

$C_0(i) \leftarrow i \cdot \gamma$

end for

▷ Process the matrix column by column

for $j \leftarrow 1$ **to** n **do**

$C_j(0) \leftarrow 0$

$i_j^* \leftarrow 0$

$i \leftarrow 1$

while $i \leq i_{j-1}^*$ **do**

$$C_j(i) \leftarrow \min \begin{cases} C_{j-1}(i-1) + \text{cost}(x[i], y[j]), \\ C_{j-1}(i) + \gamma, \\ C_j(i-1) + \gamma \end{cases}$$

if $C_j(i) \leq k$ **then**

$i_j^* \leftarrow i$

end if

$i \leftarrow i + 1$

end while

if $i \leq m$ **then**

$$C_j(i) \leftarrow \min \begin{cases} C_{j-1}(i-1) + \text{cost}(x[i], y[j]), \\ C_j(i-1) + \gamma \end{cases}$$

if $C_j(i) \leq k$ **then**

$i_j^* \leftarrow i$

end if

$i \leftarrow i + 1$

while $i \leq m$ **and** $C_j(i-1) + \gamma \leq k$ **do**

$C_j(i) \leftarrow C_j(i-1) + \gamma$

if $C_j(i) \leq k$ **then**

$i_j^* \leftarrow i$

end if

$i \leftarrow i + 1$

end while

end if

if $i_j^* = m$ **and** $C_j(m) \leq k$ **then**

return $(j, C_j(m))$

end if

end for

CHAPTER 4

Biologically Inspired Alignment Scores

The unit cost edit distance simply counts certain differences between strings. There is no inherent biological meaning behind this scheme. If we want to compare DNA or protein sequences, for example, biologically more meaningful distances should be used.

Definition 4.1 Transversion/transition cost Biologisch motivierte Kostenfunktion auf dem DNA-Alphabet: Purin/Purin- und Pyrimidin/Pyrimidin-Ersetzungen (Transitionen) kosten 1, Purin/Pyrimidin-Ersetzungen (Transversionen) kosten 2; oft mit Indel-Kosten 3. Reflektiert, dass Transitionen wahrscheinlicher sind als Transversionen.

The following is called the *transversion/transition cost* on the DNA alphabet:

	A	G	C	T
A	0	1	2	2
G	1	0	2	2
C	2	2	0	1
T	2	2	1	0

Bases A and G are called *purines*, and bases C and T are called *pyrimidines*. The transversion/transition cost function reflects the biological fact that a purine/purine and a pyrimidine/pyrimidine replacement is more likely to occur than a purine/pyrimidine replacement. Often, an insertion/deletion cost of 3 is used with the above costs to take into account that a deletion or an insertion of a base is even more seldom. These costs define the transition/transversion distance between two DNA sequences.

To compare protein sequences and define a cost function on the amino acid alphabet, we may count how many DNA bases must change minimally in a codon to transform one amino acid into another.

A more sophisticated cost function for replacement of amino acids was calculated by W. Taylor according to the method described in Taylor and Jones (1993) and is shown in Table 4.1. (To completely define a distance function, we would also have to define the costs for insertions and deletions.)

Note 4.1 Note, however, that in a distance model a match has always zero cost, $\text{cost}(\frac{a}{a}) = 0$ for all $a \in \Sigma$. This restricts flexibility a little bit because any match is scored in the same way.

	A	R	N	D	C	Q	E	G	H	I	L	K	M	F	P	S	T	W	Y	V
A	0	14	7	9	20	9	8	7	12	13	17	11	14	24	7	6	4	32	23	11
R	14	0	11	15	26	11	14	17	11	18	19	7	16	25	13	12	13	25	24	18
N	7	11	0	6	23	5	6	10	7	16	19	7	16	25	10	7	7	30	23	15
D	9	15	6	0	25	6	3	9	11	19	22	10	19	29	11	11	10	34	27	17
C	20	26	23	25	0	26	25	21	25	22	26	25	26	26	22	20	21	34	22	21
Q	9	11	5	6	26	0	5	12	7	17	20	8	16	27	10	11	10	32	26	16
E	8	14	6	3	25	5	0	9	10	17	21	10	17	28	11	10	9	34	26	16
G	7	17	10	9	21	12	9	0	15	17	21	13	18	27	10	9	9	33	26	15
H	12	11	7	11	25	7	10	15	0	17	19	10	17	24	13	11	11	30	21	16
I	13	18	16	19	22	17	17	17	17	0	9	17	8	17	16	14	12	31	18	4
L	17	19	19	22	26	20	21	21	19	9	0	19	7	14	20	19	17	27	18	10
K	11	7	7	10	25	8	10	13	10	17	19	0	15	26	11	10	10	29	25	16
M	14	16	16	19	26	16	17	18	17	8	7	15	0	18	17	16	13	29	20	8
F	24	25	25	29	26	27	28	27	24	17	14	26	18	0	27	24	23	24	8	19
P	7	13	10	11	22	10	11	10	13	16	20	11	17	27	0	9	8	32	26	14
S	6	12	7	11	20	11	10	9	11	14	19	10	16	24	9	0	5	29	22	13
T	4	13	7	10	21	10	9	9	11	12	17	10	13	23	8	5	0	31	22	10
W	32	25	30	34	34	32	34	33	30	31	27	29	29	24	32	29	31	0	25	32
Y	23	24	23	27	22	26	26	26	21	18	18	25	20	8	26	22	22	25	0	20
V	11	18	15	17	21	16	16	15	16	4	10	16	8	19	14	13	10	32	20	0

Table 4.1: Amino acid replacement costs as suggested by W. Taylor.

4.1 | Sensible Similarity Scores

Definition 4.2 Sensible score function Funktion $\text{score} : \mathcal{A}(\Sigma) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ mit $\text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ a \end{pmatrix}\right) \geq 0 \geq \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ - \end{pmatrix}\right) = \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} - \\ a \end{pmatrix}\right)$, $\text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ a \end{pmatrix}\right) \geq \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ c \end{pmatrix}\right) = \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} c \\ a \end{pmatrix}\right)$ und $\text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ c \end{pmatrix}\right) \geq \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ - \end{pmatrix}\right) + \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} - \\ c \end{pmatrix}\right)$ (Symmetrie; Selbst-Ähnlichkeit maximal; Substitution besser als Deletion+Insertion).

The concept of a metric is useful because it embodies the essential properties of our intuition about distances. For example, if the triangle inequality is violated, we could find a shorter way from x to y via a detour over z , which is not intuitive. However, distances also have disadvantages, as we have seen in the discussion of local alignment, where distance functions are not useful.

Definition 4.3 General similarity score Allgemeine Ähnlichkeitsfunktion, bei der Matches positiv, Mismatches und Indels negativ bewertet werden – im Gegensatz zu einem Distanzmodell, in dem ein Match stets Kosten 0 hat. Nützlich insbesondere fürs lokale Alignment, wo Distanzfunktionen ungeeignet sind.

Similarity scores, instead, where matches are scored positively, while mismatches and indels receive negative scores, provide a useful alternative. Here we consider a general similarity score that should satisfy certain intuitive properties.

Definition 4.4 A *sensible score function* for columns in a pairwise alignment is a function $\text{score} : \mathcal{A}(\Sigma) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ such that

$$\begin{aligned} \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ a \end{pmatrix}\right) &\geq 0 \geq \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ - \end{pmatrix}\right) = \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} - \\ a \end{pmatrix}\right) && \text{for all } a \in \Sigma \\ \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ a \end{pmatrix}\right) &\geq \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ c \end{pmatrix}\right) = \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} c \\ a \end{pmatrix}\right) && \text{for all } a, c \in \Sigma \\ \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ c \end{pmatrix}\right) &\geq \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} a \\ - \end{pmatrix}\right) + \text{score}\left(\begin{pmatrix} - \\ c \end{pmatrix}\right) && \text{for all } a, c \in \Sigma \end{aligned}$$

The first and second conditions impose symmetry and state that the similarity between a and itself is always higher than between a and anything else. In particular, insertions and deletions never score positively. The third condition states that a direct substitution is preferable to a deletion followed by an insertion.

In general, it is a good idea to verify that a score function is sensible, like in the case of log-odds score matrices

introduced in the next section. In other cases, one might deviate from this property for good reason, see Section 4.3.

4.2 | Log-Odds Score Matrices

Now it is time to discuss how we can define similarity scores for biological sequences from an evolutionary point of view; we focus on proteins and define a similarity function on the alphabet Σ of 20 amino acids.

The basic observation is that over evolutionary time-scales, in functional proteins two similar amino acids are replaced more frequently by each other than dissimilar amino acids. The twist is now to define similarity by observing how often one amino acid is replaced by another one in a given amount of time.

Definition 4.5 Frequency vector Vektor $\pi = (\pi_a)_{a \in \Sigma}$ der natürlich vorkommenden Aminosäuren mit $\pi_a \geq 0$ für alle $a \in \Sigma$ und $\sum_{a \in \Sigma} \pi_a = 1$. Für zwei zufällige Positionen ist die Wahrscheinlichkeit des geordneten Paares (a, b) gleich $\pi_a \cdot \pi_b$.

Let $\pi = (\pi_a)_{a \in \Sigma}$ be the frequency vector, which means that $\pi_a \geq 0$ for all $a \in \Sigma$ and $\sum_{a \in \Sigma} \pi_a = 1$, of the naturally occurring amino acids. If we look at two random positions in two randomly selected proteins, the probability that we see the ordered pair (a, b) is then $\pi_a \cdot \pi_b$. The entries of π are also called *background frequencies* of the amino acids.

Definition 4.6 Background frequencies Die Einträge des frequency vector π ; gewinnbar als Randverteilungen (Marginals) von M_t : $\pi_a = \sum_{b \in \Sigma} M_t(a, b)$ und $\pi_b = \sum_{a \in \Sigma} M_t(a, b)$ (wegen Symmetrie).

Now assume that we can track the fate of individual amino acids over a fixed evolutionary time period t .

Definition 4.7 Fixed evolutionary time period Zeitraum t , über den die Ersetzung einzelner Aminosäuren verfolgt wird. t ist so zu wählen, dass die Score-Matrix zum Problem passt: Für Sequenzen mit gemeinsamem Vorfahren vor $\approx t/2$ sollte eine aus Paaren mit Divergenz t konstruierte Matrix genutzt werden.

Let $M_t(a, b)$ be the observed frequency table of homologous amino acid pairs where we observed a at the beginning of the period and b at the end of the period, such that $\sum_{a, b} M_t(a, b) = 1$. Usually, we count substitutions and identities twice, i.e., once in each direction. This ensures the symmetry of M_t : $M_t(a, b) = M_t(b, a)$. The reason is that we can in fact not track amino acids during evolution; we can only observe the state of two present-day sequences and do not know their most recent common ancestor. The fields of molecular evolution and phylogenetics examine more of the resulting implications.

We can find the background frequencies as the marginals of M_t : $\pi_a = \sum_{b \in \Sigma} M_t(a, b)$ and $\pi_b = \sum_{a \in \Sigma} M_t(a, b)$ because of symmetry.

There are two reasons why an entry $M_t(a, b)$ can be relatively large. The first reason is the one we are interested in: because a and b are similar. The second reason is that simply a or b could be frequent amino acids. To remove the second effect, we consider the so-called *likelihood ratio* $M_t(a, b)/(\pi_a \cdot \pi_b)$, which relates the probability of the pair (a, b) in an evolutionary model to its probability in a random model.

Definition 4.8 Likelihood ratio Verhältnis $M_t(a, b)/(\pi_a \cdot \pi_b)$, das die Wahrscheinlichkeit des Paares (a, b) im Evolutionsmodell zu der im Zufallsmodell in Beziehung setzt. Werte > 1 bedeuten Ähnlichkeit, Werte < 1 Unähnlichkeit von a und b .

We declare that a and b are similar if this ratio exceeds 1 and that they are dissimilar if this ratio is below 1.

Definition 4.9 Log-odds score matrix Additive Score-Matrix bzgl. Zeitraum t , definiert als Logarithmus der likelihood ratio: $\text{score}_t(a, b) := \log\left(\frac{M_t(a, b)}{\pi_a \cdot \pi_b}\right)$. Wichtige Familien: PAM(t) und BLOSUM(s).

To obtain an additive function, we take the logarithm and define the *log-odds score matrix* with respect to time period t by

$$\text{score}_t(a, b) := \log \left(\frac{M_t(a, b)}{\pi_a \cdot \pi_b} \right).$$

The time parameter t should be chosen in such a way that the score matrix is optimal for the problem at hand: If we want to compare two sequences whose most recent common ancestor existed, say, 530 million years ago, then we should ideally use a score matrix constructed from sequence pairs with distance $t \approx 1060$ million years.

Bemerkung 4.1 For convenience, scores are often scaled by a constant factor and then rounded to integers. The score unit is called a *bit* if the score is obtained by a $\log_2(\cdot)$ operation. When multiplied by a factor of three, say, we get scores in *third-bits*.

Definition 4.10 Third-bits Score-Einheit: Ein Score ist in *bits*, wenn er per $\log_2(\cdot)$ gebildet wird; wird er zusätzlich mit dem Faktor 3 multipliziert (und gerundet), erhält man Scores in third-bits.

Bemerkung 4.2 Since we cannot easily observe how DNA or proteins change over millions of years, constructing a score matrix is somewhat difficult. Since the pioneering work of Margaret Dayhoff and colleagues in the 1970s, Markov processes are used to model molecular evolution. Methods that allow to integrate information from sequences of different divergence times in a consistent fashion have been developed more recently.

Bemerkung 4.3 Important score matrix families for proteins are the PAM(t) (Dayhoff et al., 1978) and the BLOSUM(s) (Henikoff and Henikoff, 1992) matrices. Here t is a divergence time parameter and s is a clustering similarity parameter inversely correlated to t . (The inventors of BLOSUM have chosen to index their matrices in a different way.) The BLOSUM matrices are the most widely used ones for protein sequence comparison.

4.3 | Non-symmetric score matrices

We usually demand that similarity functions and hence score matrices are symmetric. In some cases, however, there are good reasons to choose a non-symmetric similarity function. Often then, the unsymmetry does not stem from an unsymmetry of M_t (for reasons explained above), but from different background frequencies. We mention an example.

Assume that we have a particular protein fragment (the “query”) that forms a transmembrane helix. The amino acid composition in membrane regions differs strongly from that of the “average” protein: It is hydrophobically biased. Assume that we want to look for similar fragments in a large database of peptide sequences (of unknown or “average” type). It follows that the matrix M_t of pair frequencies should be one derived from an evolutionary process acting on transmembrane helices and that two different types of background frequencies should be used: The query background frequencies τ are those of the transmembrane model, different from the background frequencies π of the database. It follows that we should use

$$\text{score}_t(a, b) := \log \left(\frac{M_t(a, b)}{\tau_a \cdot \pi_b} \right),$$

or a rounded multiple thereof, so that now $\text{score}(a, b) \neq \text{score}(b, a)$ in general. Table 4.2 shows the SLIM161 matrix for transmembrane helices (Müller et al., 2001). The 161 is the time parameter t referring to the expected number of evolutionary events per 100 positions.

	A	R	N	D	C	Q	E	G	H	I	L	K	M	F	P	S	T	W	Y	V
A	5	-8	-5	-10	3	-7	-11	0	-5	1	1	-10	1	1	-5	2	1	-2	-3	2
R	-3	10	-4	-10	-2	-3	-11	-4	-4	-2	-1	-3	-1	-2	-7	-4	-3	-2	-3	-3
N	-1	-5	8	-2	0	-2	-7	-2	2	-1	-1	-6	0	1	-5	2	0	-2	2	-2
D	-3	-9	1	9	-4	-2	1	-2	-2	-2	-2	-6	-2	-1	-5	-3	-3	-3	-2	-2
C	2	-8	-5	-11	11	-7	-12	-3	-8	0	1	-12	1	3	-11	2	0	-1	0	1
Q	-1	-2	0	-3	0	7	-4	-2	0	0	0	-4	2	2	-4	0	-1	4	1	0
E	-3	-7	-2	3	-2	-1	7	-3	-1	-2	-2	-8	-1	0	-4	-1	-3	-1	-1	-2
G	1	-7	-4	-7	0	-5	-10	7	-7	-1	0	-8	0	1	-5	1	-1	-3	-2	-1
H	-1	-5	3	-5	-2	-1	-5	-4	10	-1	-1	-8	-1	2	-7	-1	-2	1	5	-2
I	-1	-9	-7	-11	-1	-7	-12	-4	-7	6	3	-11	4	2	-6	-3	-1	-2	-3	4
L	-1	-8	-6	-10	1	-7	-12	-4	-7	4	5	-11	4	3	-7	-3	-1	-1	-2	2
K	-1	2	-1	-4	-2	0	-7	-1	-3	0	-1	6	0	0	-1	-1	-1	-1	1	-2
M	-1	-7	-6	-10	1	-5	-11	-3	-7	4	4	-11	7	3	-7	-2	0	-1	-2	2
F	-1	-9	-5	-10	2	-6	-11	-3	-4	1	2	-11	2	8	-7	-2	-2	3	4	0
P	-3	-9	-7	-9	-7	-8	-10	-4	-9	-2	-3	-8	-3	-2	11	-3	-3	-3	-4	-2
S	2	-8	-1	-8	4	-5	-9	0	-4	0	0	-9	0	1	-5	6	1	-2	-1	0
T	2	-7	-3	-8	2	-6	-10	-2	-5	2	2	-9	3	2	-4	2	4	-4	-2	2
W	-3	-7	-6	-10	0	-2	-11	-5	-3	-1	0	-10	0	4	-6	-4	-5	15	2	-2
Y	-4	-8	-2	-9	1	-5	-10	-5	0	-2	-1	-8	-1	6	-7	-3	-3	2	11	-2
V	1	-9	-7	-10	1	-7	-11	-4	-7	5	3	-12	3	2	-6	-2	0	-2	-3	5

Table 4.2: The non-symmetric SLIM 161 score matrix. Scores are given in third-bits, i.e., as $\text{score}(a, b) = \text{round}(3 \cdot \log_2(M(a, b)/(\tau_a \pi_b)))$.

4.4 | Position-Specific Scores

The match/mismatch score in all our alignment algorithms depends on a (sensible) similarity function score as defined in Definition 4.1, often given by a log-odds score matrix. However, this does not need to be the case. The algorithm does not change in any way if indel and match/mismatch scores depend also on the position in the sequences. Therefore we can replace $\text{score}(x[i], y[j])$ by $\text{score}(i, j)$ and worry later about where to obtain reasonable score values.

A useful application of this observation is as follows: Local alignment is often used in large-scale database searches to find remote homologs of a given protein. Transmembrane (TM) proteins have an unusual sequence composition (which has a large influence on the score matrix entries, as pointed out in Section 4.2). According to Müller et al. (2001), one can increase the sensitivity of the homology search by using a bipartite scoring scheme with a (non-symmetric) transmembrane helix specific scoring matrix (such as SLIM) for the TM helices and a general-purpose scoring matrix (such as BLOSUM) for the remaining regions of the query protein; see Figure 4.1. As a consequence, the score of aligning $x[i]$ with $y[j]$ does not only depend on the amino acids $x[i]$ and $y[j]$ themselves, but also on the position i within the query sequence x . [1]

RNA Secondary Structure Prediction

5.1 | Introduction

RNA is in many ways similar to DNA, with a few important differences:

- Thymine (T) is replaced by uracil (U), so the RNA alphabet is $\Sigma_{\text{RNA}} = \{\text{A}, \text{C}, \text{G}, \text{U}\}$.
- The additional base pair $\{\text{G}, \text{U}\}$ can be formed.
- RNA is less stable than DNA and more easily degraded.
- RNA mostly occurs as a single-stranded molecule that forms secondary structures by base pairing.
- While DNA is mainly the carrier of genetic information, RNA has a wide variety of tasks in the cell, e.g.
 - it acts as messenger (mRNA), transporting the transcribed genetic information,
 - it has regulatory functions,
 - it has structural tasks, e.g. in forming a part of the ribosome (rRNA),
 - it takes an active role in cellular processes, e.g. in the translation of mRNA to proteins, by transferring amino acids (tRNA).

As with proteins, the three-dimensional structure of an RNA molecule is crucial in determining its function. Since 3D-structure is hard to determine, an intermediate structural level, the *secondary structure*, is frequently considered. The secondary structure of an RNA molecule simply determines the intra-molecular basepairs. As with DNA, the Watson-Crick pairs $\{\text{A}, \text{U}\}$ and $\{\text{C}, \text{G}\}$ stabilize the molecule, but also the “wobble pair” $\{\text{G}, \text{U}\}$ adds structural stability. We now define this formally.

Let $s \in \{\text{A}, \text{C}, \text{G}, \text{U}\}^n$ be an RNA sequence of length n .

Definition 5.1 An *s-basepair* is a set of two different numbers $\{i, j\} \subset \{1, \dots, n\}$ such that $\{s[i], s[j]\} \in \{\{\text{A}, \text{U}\}, \{\text{C}, \text{G}\}, \{\text{G}, \text{U}\}\}$. Basepairs must bridge at least $\delta \geq 0$ positions (e.g. $\delta = 3$); to account for this, we have the additional constraint $|i - j| > \delta$ for a basepair $\{i, j\}$.

Definition 5.2 A *simple structure* on s is a set $S = \{b_1, b_2, \dots, b_N\}$ of s -basepairs with $N \geq 0$ and the following properties:

- Either $N \leq 1$, or
- if $N \geq 2$ and $\{i, j\} \in S$ and $\{k, l\} \in S$ are two different basepairs such that $i < j$ and $k < l$, then $i < k < l < j$ or $k < i < j < l$ (nested basepairs) or $i < j < k < l$ or $k < l < i < j$ (separated basepairs).

In other words, basepairs in a simple structure may not cross.

The restriction that basepairs may not cross is actually unrealistic, but it helps to keep several computational problems regarding RNA analysis of manageable complexity, as we shall see shortly.

With the above definition of a simple structure, we cover the following structural elements of RNA molecules: *single-stranded RNA*, *stem* or *stacking region*, *hairpin loop*, *bulge loop*, *interior loop*, *junction* or *multi-loop*;

Several more complex RNA interactions are *not* covered, e.g. *pseudoknot*, *kissing hairpins*, *hairpin-bulge contact*. This is not such a severe restriction, because these elements seem to be comparatively rare and can be considered separately at a later stage.

We point out that all of the above structural elements can be rigorously defined in terms of sets of basepairs. For our purposes, an intuitive visual understanding of these elements is sufficient. There exist different ways to represent a simple structure in the computer. A popular way is the *dot-bracket* notation, where dots represent unpaired bases and corresponding parentheses represent paired bases:

```
5' AACGCUCCCAUAGAUUACCGUACAAAGUAGGGCGC 3'
..(((.(...((...)).(.(...))....)))..
```

Another popular way to visualize a structure is by means of a *mountain plot*: Starting with the dot-bracket representation, replace dots by – and brackets () by /\, and use a second dimension. Another alternative is a *circle plot*;

5.2 | The Optimization Problem

Over time, an RNA molecule may assume several distinct structures. The more energetically stable a structure is, the more likely the molecule will assume this structure. To make this precise, we need to define an energy model for all secondary structure elements. This can become quite complicated (the problem of predicting RNA structures could fill an entire course), so here we only consider a drastically simplified version of the problem: We assign a score (that can be interpreted as “stability” measure or negative free energy) to each basepair, depending on its type. We can simply count basepairs by assigning +1 to each pair, or we may take their relative stability into account by assigning $\text{score}(\{A, U\}) := 2$, $\text{score}(\{C, G\}) := 3$, $\text{score}(\{G, U\}) := 1$, for example. On a sequence s of length n , the score of a basepair $b = \{i, j\}$ is then defined as $\text{score}(b) := \text{score}(\{s[i], s[j]\})$.

Problem 5.1 Simple RNA Secondary Structure Prediction Problem Let an RNA sequence s of length n be given, determine a simple structure S^* on s such that

$$\text{score}(S^*) = \max\{\text{score}(S) \mid S \text{ is a simple structure on } s\},$$

where $\text{score}(S) := \sum_{b \in S} \text{score}(b)$ is the sum of the base pair scores in the structure S .

Generally, the number of valid simple structures for a molecule of length n is exponential in n , so the most stable structure cannot be found in reasonable time by enumerating all possible structures. After a short digression to context free grammars, we present an efficient algorithm to solve the problem.

5.3 | Context-Free Grammars

From the above discussion of the dot-bracket notation, we may say that a (simple secondary) structure is

0. either the empty structure,
1. or an unpaired base, followed by a structure,
2. or a structure, followed by an unpaired base,

3. or an outer basepair (with a sequence constraint), enclosing a structure (with a minimum length constraint),
4. or two consecutive structures.

We recall the notion of a *context-free grammar* here to show that simple secondary structures allow a straightforward recursive description.

Definition 5.3 A *context-free grammar* (CFG) is a quadruple $G = (N, T, P, S)$, where

- N is a finite set of *non-terminal symbols*,
- T is a finite set of *terminal symbols*, $N \cap T = \emptyset$,
- P is a finite subset of $N \times (N \cup T)^*$, the *productions*, which are rules for transforming a non-terminal symbol into a (possibly empty) sequence of terminal and non-terminal symbols, and
- $S \in N$ is the *start symbol*.

Ignoring basepair sequence and distance constraints, in the RNA structure setting, the terminal symbols are $T = \{ (, .,) \}$ and $N = \{ S \}$, where S is also the start symbol and represents a secondary structure. The productions are formalized versions of the above rules, i.e.,

0. $S \rightarrow \varepsilon$, where ε denotes the empty sequence,
1. $S \rightarrow .S$
2. $S \rightarrow S.$
3. $S \rightarrow (S)$
4. $S \rightarrow SS$

Note that this context-free recursive description is only possible because we imposed the constraint that basepairs do not cross.

Also note that this grammar is ambiguous: There are generally many ways to produce a given dot-bracket string from the start symbol S . For the Nussinov Algorithm in the next section, this ambiguity is not a problem. However, for other tasks, e.g. counting the number of possible structures, we need to consider a grammar that produces each structure in a unique way. We can argue as follows: Either the structure is empty, or it contains at least one base. In each nonempty RNA structure, look at the last base. Either it is unpaired and preceded by a (shorter) prefix structure, or it is paired with some base at a previous position. We obtain the following non-ambiguous grammar:

$$S \rightarrow \varepsilon \mid S. \mid S(S)$$

where the vertical bar ($\mid$) denotes “or”, i.e., it separates alternative right-hand sides of the production.

5.4 | The Nussinov Algorithm

Example calculation for GGUCCA on page 51.

To solve Problem 5.1, we now give a dynamic programming algorithm based on the structural description of simple secondary structures from the previous section. This algorithm is due to Nussinov and Jacobson (1980). We also take into account the distance and sequence constraints for basepairs.

In the previous section, we have seen how to build longer secondary structures from shorter ones that can be arbitrary substrings of the longer ones. As before, let $s \in \{A, C, G, U\}^n$ be an RNA sequence of length n . For $i \leq j$, we define $M(i, j)$ as the solution to Problem 5.1 (i.e., maximally attainable score) for the string $s[i \dots j]$.

Since it is easy to find an optimal secondary structure of short sequences, let us start with those.

- If $j - i \leq \delta$ (in particular if $i = j$, and to avoid complications also if $i > j$), then $M(i, j) = 0$, since no basepair is possible due to the length or distance constraints (case 0).
- If $j - i > \delta$, then we can decompose the optimal structure according to one of the four cases. In each case, the resulting substructures must also be the optimal ones. Thus

$$M(i, j) = \max \begin{cases} M(i+1, j) & \text{(case 1: } S \rightarrow .S) \\ M(i, j-1) & \text{(case 2: } S \rightarrow S.) \\ M(i+1, j-1) + \mu(i, j) & \text{(case 3: } S \rightarrow (S)) \\ \max_{i+1 < k < j} \{M(i, k-1) + M(k, j)\} & \text{(all cases 4: } S \rightarrow SS) \end{cases}$$

where $\mu(i, j) := \text{score}(\{s[i], s[j]\}) > 0$ if $\{s[i], s[j]\}$ is a valid basepair, and $\mu(i, j) := -\infty$ otherwise, excluding the possibility of any forbidden basepair $\{i, j\}$.

This recurrence states: To find an optimal structure for $s[i \dots j]$, consider all possible decompositions according to the grammar and their respective scores, and evaluate which score for $s[i \dots j]$ would result from each decomposition. Then pick the best one.

This is possible because the composing elements of the optimal structure are themselves optimal. The proof is by contradiction: If they were not optimal and there existed better sub-structures, we could build a better overall structure from them, which would contradict its optimality.

The above recurrence has still to be developed into an algorithm. In order to evaluate $M(i, j)$, we need access to all entries $M(x, y)$ for which $[x, y]$ is a (strictly shorter) subinterval of $[i, j]$. This suggests to compute matrix M in order of increasing $j - i$ values. The initialization for $j - i \leq \delta$ is easily done. Then we proceed for increasing $d = j - i$, as in Algorithm 2.

Algorithm 2 Nussinov Algorithm

Input: RNA sequence $s = s[1 \dots n]$, scoring function for basepairs, minimum number δ of unpaired bases in a hairpin loop

Output: Maximal score $M(i, j)$ for a simple secondary structure of each substring $s[i \dots j]$ and traceback indicators $T(i, j)$ indicating which case leads to the optimum

```

1: for  $i \leftarrow 2$  to  $n$  do
2:    $M(i, i-1) \leftarrow 0$ 
3:    $T(i, i-1) \leftarrow \text{"init"}$  ▷  $\epsilon$  (unpaired)
4: end for
5: for  $d \leftarrow 0$  to  $\delta$  do
6:   for  $i \leftarrow 1$  to  $n - d$  do
7:      $M(i, i+d) \leftarrow 0$ 
8:      $T(i, i+d) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$  ▷  $.S$  and/or  $S.$  (case 1 or 2)
9:   end for
10: end for
11: for  $d \leftarrow \delta + 1$  to  $n - 1$  do
12:   for  $i \leftarrow 1$  to  $n - d$  do
13:     Compute  $M(i, i+d)$  according to the recurrence
14:     Store the maximizing case in  $T(i, i+d)$  ▷ cases 1–3; or case 4 with maximizing  $k$ 
15:   end for
16: end for
17: Report score  $M(1, n)$ 
18: Start traceback with  $T(1, n)$ 
```

To find an optimal secondary structure (in addition to the optimal score), we also store traceback indicators in a second matrix T that shows which of the production rules (and which value of k for the $S \rightarrow SS$ rule) was used at each step. By following the traceback pointers backwards, we can build the dot-bracket representation of the secondary structure. For this, we start in cell $(1, n)$ and look at the recursion of the algorithm: When we follow a $S \rightarrow SS$ production traceback, the process branches recursively into the two substructures, reconstructing each substructure

independently. Diagonals mean $S \rightarrow (S)$ and horizontal or vertical movement means $S \rightarrow S. \mid .S$. Note that when reaching the δ -diagonals only horizontal and vertical movement is allowed. Finally, when we end in the lowest diagonal (below the $i = j$ diagonal) we have $S \rightarrow \varepsilon$.

Analysis. The memory requirement for the whole procedure is obviously $O(n^2)$ and its time complexity is $O(n^3)$.

There exists a faster algorithm using the Four-Russians speedup yielding an $O\left(\frac{n^3}{\log n}\right)$ time algorithm (Frid and Gusfield, 2009), but this goes far beyond the scope of these lecture notes.

CHAPTER 6

Pairwise Sequence Alignment in Linear Space

6.1 | The Forward-Backward Technique

TODO

6.2 | Hirschberg's Algorithm

TODO

Suboptimal Local Alignments

Example calculation on page 58.

Algorithm 3 Smith-Waterman Darstellung nach Skript

Sequences to be aligned: $A = a_1a_2 \dots a_n$ and $B = b_1b_2 \dots b_m$

score(x,y): Similarity score of x and y

Gap cost: γ

$S(0,0) \leftarrow 0$

for $i \leftarrow 1$ to n **do**

$S(i,0) \leftarrow 0$

end for

for $j \leftarrow 1$ to m **do**

$S(0,j) \leftarrow 0$

end for

for $j \leftarrow 1$ to n **do**

for $i \leftarrow 1$ to n **do**

$$S(i,j) \leftarrow \max \begin{cases} S(0,0) & = 0(\text{leeres Suffix}) \\ S(i-1,j-1) + \text{score}(x[i], y[j]) & = \text{links oben} + \text{sim score}((\text{Mis-})\text{Match}) \\ S(i-1,j) - \gamma & = \text{oben(Deletion)} \\ S(i,j-1) - \gamma & = \text{links(Insertion)} \end{cases}$$

end for

end for

Traceback

Algorithm 4 Smith-Waterman Darstellung angepasst

Sequences to be aligned: $A = a_1a_2 \dots a_n$ and $B = b_1b_2 \dots b_m$

s(x,y): Similarity score of x and y

$S(0,0) \leftarrow 0$

for $i \leftarrow 1$ to n **do**

$S(i,0) \leftarrow 0$

end for

for $j \leftarrow 1$ to m **do**

$S(0,j) \leftarrow 0$

end for

for $j \leftarrow 1$ to n **do**

for $i \leftarrow 1$ to n **do**

$$S(i,j) \leftarrow \max \begin{cases} 0 \\ S(i-1,j-1) + s(x[i],y[j]) \\ S(i-1,j) - s(x[i],-) \\ S(i,j-1) - s(-,y[j]) \end{cases}$$

end for

end for

Traceback

Example calculation on page 60.

Algorithm 5 ONE(!) suboptimal Alignment through Waterman-Eggert

Input S: matrix calculated by Smith-Waterman

Take the calculated matrix from Smith-Waterman and set all cells that contribute to the optimal alignment to 0.

$i_{start} \leftarrow$ start row

for $i \leftarrow i_{start}$ to n **do**

for $j \leftarrow 1$ to m **do**

if (i, j) belongs to optimal alignment **then**

$S(i,j) = 0$

else

$$S(i,j) \leftarrow \max \begin{cases} 0 \\ S(i-1,j-1) + s(x[i],y[j]) \\ S(i-1,j) - s(x[i],-) \\ S(i,j-1) - s(-,y[j]) \end{cases}$$

end if

end for

end for

To calculate the k best non-overlapping alignments, repeat the above k times while inputting the result matrix of the previous run.

CHAPTER 8

Exact Algorithms for Sum-of-Pairs Multiple Sequence Alignment

CHAPTER 9

An Approximation Algorithm for Sum-of-Pairs Multiple Sequence Alignment

CHAPTER 10

Heuristics for Multiple Sequence Alignment

CHAPTER 11

Examples and longer explanations

11.1 | Nussinov example

Input: RNA sequence $s = GGUCCA$ (meaning $n = 6$), scoring function for base pairs, minimum number $\delta = 1$ of unpaired bases in a hairpin loop

First loop

todo what does it

for $i \leftarrow 2$ to 6 **do**

$M(i, i-1) \leftarrow 0$

$T(i, i-1) \leftarrow \text{"init"}$

end for

$\triangleright \epsilon$ (case 0)

$M =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		0				
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						

(a) $M(2, 1) \leftarrow 0$

$T =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2						
3						
4						
5						
6						

(b) $T(2, 1) \leftarrow \text{"init"}$

Figure 11.1: $i = 2$ (first iteration)

$M =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		0				
2			0			
3						
4						
5						
6						

(a) $M(3, 2) \leftarrow 0$

$T =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2			init			
3						
4						
5						
6						

(b) $T(3, 2) \leftarrow \text{"init"}$

Figure 11.2: $i = 3$ (second iteration)

$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		0				
2			0			
3				0		
4						
5						
6						

(a) $M(4, 3) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2			init			
3				init		
4						
5						
6						

(b) $T(4, 3) \leftarrow \text{"init"}$ **Figure 11.3:** $i = 4$ (third iteration)
$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		0				
2			0			
3				0		
4					0	
5						
6						

(a) $M(5, 4) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2			init			
3				init		
4					init	
5						
6						

(b) $T(5, 4) \leftarrow \text{"init"}$ **Figure 11.4:** $i = 5$ (fourth iteration)
$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		0				
2			0			
3				0		
4					0	
5						0
6						

(a) $M(6, 5) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2			init			
3				init		
4					init	
5						init
6						

(b) $T(6, 5) \leftarrow \text{"init"}$ **Figure 11.5:** $i = 6$ (fifth iteration)**Second loop****for** $d \leftarrow 0$ to 1 **do****for** $i \leftarrow 1$ to 5 **do** $M(i, i + d) \leftarrow 0$ $T(i, i + d) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$ **end for****end for** $\triangleright .S$ and/or S . (case 1 or 2)**First iteration of sub-loop**

$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2			0			
3				0		
4					0	
5						0
6						

(a) $M(1, 1) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	unpaired	init				
2			init			
3				init		
4					init	
5						init
6						

(b) $T(1, 1) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$ **Figure 11.6:** $d = 0$ und $i = 1$ (first iteration)

$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2		0				
3		0	0			
4				0		
5					0	
6						0

(a) $M(2, 2) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2	unpaired	unpaired				
3			init			
4				init		
5					init	
6						init

(b) $T(2, 2) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$ Figure 11.7: $d = 0$ und $i = 2$ (second iteration)
$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2		0				
3			0			
4				0		
5					0	
6						0

(a) $M(3, 3) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2	unpaired	unpaired				
3			init			
4			unpaired	init		
5					init	
6						init

(b) $T(3, 3) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$ Figure 11.8: $d = 0$ und $i = 3$ (third iteration)
$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2		0				
3			0			
4			0	0		
5					0	
6						0

(a) $M(4, 4) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2	unpaired	unpaired				
3			init			
4			unpaired	init		
5				unpaired	init	
6						init

(b) $T(4, 4) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$ Figure 11.9: $d = 0$ und $i = 4$ (fourth iteration)
$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2		0				
3			0			
4			0	0		
5					0	
6						0

(a) $M(5, 5) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2	unpaired	unpaired				
3			init			
4			unpaired	init		
5				unpaired	init	
6					unpaired	init

(b) $T(5, 5) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$ Figure 11.10: $d = 0$ und $i = 5$ (fifth iteration)

Second iteration of sub-loop

$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0				
3			0			
4			0	0		
5				0	0	
6					0	0

(a) $M(1, 2) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2	unpaired	unpaired				
3			init			
4			unpaired	init		
5				unpaired	init	
6					unpaired	init

(b) $T(1, 2) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$ Figure 11.11: $d = 1$ und $i = 1$ (first iteration)

$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0	0			
3		1	0			
4				0		
5					0	
6						0

(a) $M(2, 3) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2	unpaired	unpaired				
3		case 3	init	init		
4			unpaired	unpaired		
5					init	
6					unpaired	init

(b) $T(2, 3) \leftarrow \text{case}$ Figure 11.12: $d = 1$ und $i = 2$ (second iteration)
$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0	0			
3		0	0	0		
4			0	0		
5			0		0	
6					0	0

(a) $M(3, 4) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2	unpaired	unpaired				
3		unpaired	init	init		
4			unpaired	unpaired		
5			unpaired		init	
6					unpaired	init

(b) $T(3, 4) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$ Figure 11.13: $d = 1$ und $i = 3$ (third iteration)
$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0	0			
3		0	0	0		
4			0	0	0	
5				0	0	
6					0	0

(a) $M(4, 5) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2	unpaired	unpaired				
3		unpaired	init	init		
4			unpaired	unpaired		
5			unpaired	unpaired	init	
6					unpaired	init

(b) $T(4, 5) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$ Figure 11.14: $d = 1$ und $i = 4$ (fourth iteration)
$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0	0			
3		0	0	0		
4			0	0	0	
5				0	0	
6					0	0

(a) $M(5, 6) \leftarrow 0$

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1		init				
2	unpaired	unpaired				
3		unpaired	init	init		
4			unpaired	unpaired		
5			unpaired	unpaired	init	
6					unpaired	init

(b) $T(5, 6) \leftarrow \text{"unpaired"}$ Figure 11.15: $d = 1$ und $i = 5$ (fifth iteration)**Third loop****for** $d \leftarrow 2$ to 5 **do** **for** $i \leftarrow 1$ to 5 **do** Compute $M(i, i + d)$ according to the recurrence Store the maximizing case in $T(i, i + d)$ $\triangleright$ cases 1–3; or case 4 with maximizing k **end for****end for****First iteration of sub-loop**We are looking at $M(1, 3)$

Is $j - i \leq \delta$?

→ Nein $3 - 1 = 2 > 1$

Is $\{s[1], s[3]\} = \{G, U\}$ a valid base pair?

→ Wobble, yes

$$M(1, 3) = \max \begin{cases} M(2, 3) & = 0 \\ M(1, 2) & = 0 \\ M(2, 2) + \mu(2, 4) = M(2, 2) + \text{score}(\{G, U\}) = 0 + 1 & = 1 \\ \max_{2 < k < 3} \{M(1, ???) + M(???, 3)\} & = NaN \end{cases} = 1$$

 $M =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0	0			
3	1	0	0	0		
4			0	0	0	
5				0	0	0
6					0	

 $T =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	unpaired	init				
2	unpaired	unpaired	init			
3	unpaired	unpaired	unpaired	init		
4			unpaired	unpaired	init	
5				unpaired	unpaired	init
6					unpaired	

(b) $T(1, 3) \leftarrow \text{case}$

(a) Compute $M(1, 3)$ according to the recurrence

Figure 11.16: $d = 2$ und $i = 1$ (first iteration)

We are looking at $M(2, 4)$

Is $j - i \leq \delta$?

→ No $4 - 2 = 2 > 1$

Is $\{s[2], s[4]\} = \{G, C\}$ a valid base pair?

→ Yes

$$M(2, 4) = \max \begin{cases} M(3, 4) & = 0 \\ M(2, 3) & = 0 \\ M(3, 3) + \mu(2, 4) = M(3, 3) + \text{score}(\{G, C\}) = 0 + 1 & = 1 \\ \max_{3 < k < 4} \{M(2, ???) + M(???, 4)\} & = NaN \end{cases} = 1$$

 $M =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0	0			
3	1	0	0	0		
4		1	0	0	0	
5				0	0	0
6					0	

 $T =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	unpaired	init				
2	unpaired	unpaired	init			
3	case 3	unpaired	unpaired	init		
4		case 3	unpaired	unpaired	init	
5				unpaired	unpaired	init
6					unpaired	

(b) $T(2, 4) \leftarrow \text{case}$

(a) Compute $M(2, 4)$ according to the recurrence

Figure 11.17: $d = 2$ und $i = 2$ (second iteration)

We are looking at $M(3, 5)$

Is $j - i \leq \delta$?

→ No $5 - 2 = 2 > 1$

Is $\{s[3], s[5]\} = \{U, C\}$ a valid base pair?

→ No

$$M(3, 5) = \max \begin{cases} M(4, 5) & = 0 \\ M(3, 4) & = 0 \\ M(4, 4) + \mu(3, 5) = M(4, 4) + \text{score}(\{U, C\}) = 0 + 0 & = 0 \\ \max_{4 < k < 5} \{M(3, ???) + M(???, 5)\} & = NaN \end{cases} = 0$$

$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0	0			
3	1	0	0	0		
4		1	0	0	0	
5			0	0	0	0
6				0	0	

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	unpaired	init				
2	unpaired	unpaired	init			
3	case 3	unpaired	unpaired	init		
4		case 3	unpaired	unpaired	init	
5			case 1-3	unpaired	unpaired	init
6						

(b) $T(3, 5) \leftarrow \text{case}$

(a) Compute $M(3, 5)$ according to the recurrence

Figure 11.18: $d = 2$ und $i = 3$ (third iteration)

We are looking at $M(4, 6)$

Is $j - i \leq \delta$?

→ No $6 - 4 = 2 > 1$

Is $\{s[4], s[6]\} = \{C, A\}$ a valid base pair?

→ No

$$M(4, 6) = \max \begin{cases} M(5, 6) & = 0 \\ M(4, 5) & = 0 \\ M(5, 5) + \mu(4, 6) = M(5, 5) + \text{score}(\{C, A\}) = 0 + 0 & = 0 \\ \max_{5 < k < 6} \{M(4, ???) + M(???, 6)\} & = NaN \end{cases} = 0$$

$$M =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0	0			
3	1	0	0	0		
4		1	0	0	0	
5			0	0	0	0
6				0	0	

$$T =$$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	unpaired	init				
2	unpaired	unpaired	init			
3	case 3	unpaired	unpaired	init		
4		case 3	unpaired	unpaired	init	
5			case 1-3	unpaired	unpaired	init
6				case 1-3	unpaired	

(b) $T(4, 6) \leftarrow \text{case}$

(a) Compute $M(4, 6)$ according to the recurrence

Figure 11.19: $d = 2$ und $i = 4$ (fourth iteration)

$M(5, 7)$ does not exist

Iteration 2 and 3

were taken from <https://rna.informatik.uni-freiburg.de/Teaching/index.jsp?toolName=Nussinov> (with Minimal loop length $l = 1$ and Delta #bp to maximum = 0). Resulting in:

$M =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0	0			
3	1	0	0	0		
4	1	1	0	0	0	
5	2	1	0	0	0	0
6		1	1	0	0	

$T =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	unpaired	init				
2	unpaired	unpaired	init			
3	case 3	unpaired	unpaired	init		
4	–	case 3	unpaired	unpaired	init	
5	–	–	unpaired case 1-3	unpaired	unpaired	init
6		–	–	unpaired case 1-3	unpaired	

(b) $T(4, 6) \leftarrow$ case

(a) Compute $M(4, 6)$ according to the recurrence

(b) $T(4, 6) \leftarrow \text{case}$

Figure 11.20: $d = 2..3$ und $i = 1..5$ (whole iterations)

Fourth iteration of sub-loop

We are looking at $M(1, 6)$

Is $j - i \leq \delta$?

→ No $6 - 1 = 5 > 1$

Is $\{s[1], s[6]\} = \{G, A\}$ a valid base pair?

→ No

$$M(1, 6) = \max \begin{cases} M(2, 6) & = 1 \\ M(1, 5) & = 2 \\ M(2, 5) + \mu(1, 6) = M(2, 5) + \text{score}(\{G, A\}) = 1 + 0 & = 0 \\ \max_{2 < k < 6} \{M(1, k-1) + M(k, 6)\} = * & = 1 \end{cases} = 2$$

$$\begin{aligned} * \max_{2 < k < 6} \{M(1, k-1) + M(k, 6)\} &= \max \{M(1, 3-1) + M(3, 6), M(1, 4-1) + M(4, 6), M(1, 5-1) + M(5, 6)\} \\ &= \max \{M(1, 2) + M(3, 6), M(1, 3) + M(4, 6), M(1, 4) + M(5, 6)\} \\ &= \max \{0 + 1, 1 + 0, 1 + 0\} \\ &= \max \{1, 1, 1\} \\ &= 1 \end{aligned}$$

$M =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	0	0				
2	0	0	0			
3	1	0	0	0		
4	1	1	0	0	0	
5	2	1	0	0	0	0
6	2	1	1	0	0	

$T =$

j / i	G_1	G_2	U_3	C_4	C_5	A_6
1	unpaired	init				
2	unpaired	unpaired	init			
3	case 3	unpaired	unpaired	init		
4	–	case 3	unpaired	unpaired	init	
5	–	–	case 1-3	unpaired	unpaired	init
6	case 3	–	–	case 1-3	unpaired	

(b) $T(4, 6) \leftarrow \text{case}$

(a) Compute $M(4, 6)$ according to the recurrence

(b) $T(4, 6) \leftarrow \text{case}$

Figure 11.21: $d = 5$ und $i = 1$ (first iteration)

11.2 | Smith-Waterman example

Input

Sequences to be aligned: $A = GTAA$ and $B = GCTA$

Außerdem:

- Gap: $s(x, -) = s(-, x) = -1$
- Match: $s(x, y) = 3$ mit $x = y$
- Mismatch: $s(x, y) = 1$ mit $x \neq y$

$i \setminus j$		G	C	T	A
G					
T					
A					
A					

Figure 11.22: Matrix before the start of the algorithm.

Initialisation - (0,0)

$$S(0,0) \leftarrow 0$$

$i \setminus j$		G	C	T	A
	0				
G					
T					
A					
A					

Figure 11.23: .

Initialisation - first loop

```
for  $i \leftarrow 0$  to  $n$  do
   $S(i, 0) \leftarrow 0$ 
end for
```

$i \setminus j$		G	C	T	A
	0				
G	0				
T	0				
A	0				
A	0				

Initialisation - second loop

```
for  $j \leftarrow 0$  to  $m$  do
   $S(0, j) \leftarrow 0$ 
end for
```

$i \setminus j$		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0				
T	0				
A	0				
A	0				

Main step - Calculation

```
for  $j \leftarrow 1$  to  $n$  do
  for  $i \leftarrow 1$  to  $n$  do
```

$$S(i, j) \leftarrow \max \begin{cases} S(i-1, j-1) + s(a_i, b_j) \\ S(i-1, j) + s(a_i, -) \\ S(i, j-1) + s(-, b_j) \\ 0 \end{cases} = \max \begin{cases} S(i-1, j-1) + 3 & a_i = b_j \\ S(i-1, j-1) + 1 & a_i \neq b_j \\ S(i-1, j) + -1 & b_j = - \\ S(i, j-1) + -1 & a_i = - \\ 0 \end{cases}$$

end for
end for

j = 1, i = 1:

$$S(1,1) = \max \begin{cases} S(0,0) + 3 = 3 \\ S(0,1) + -1 = -1 \\ S(1,0) + -1 = -1 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 3$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3			
T	0				
A	0				
A	0				

j = 2, i = 1:

$$S(1,2) = \max \begin{cases} S(0,1) + 1 = 1 \\ S(0,2) + -1 = -1 \\ S(1,1) + -1 = 3 - 1 = 2 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 2$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3	2		
T	0				
A	0				
A	0				

j = 3, i = 1:

$$S(1,3) = \max \begin{cases} S(0,2) + 1 = 1 \\ S(0,3) + -1 = -1 \\ S(1,2) + -1 = 2 - 1 = 1 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 1$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3	2	1	
T	0				
A	0				
A	0				

j = 4, i = 1:

$$S(1,4) = \max \begin{cases} S(0,3) + 1 = 1 \\ S(0,4) + -1 = -1 \\ S(1,3) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 1$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3	2	1	1
T	0				
A	0				
A	0				

j = 1, i = 2:

$$S(2,1) = \max \begin{cases} S(1,0) + 0 + 1 = 1 \\ S(1,1) + -1 = 3 - 1 = 2 \\ S(2,0) + -1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 2$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3	2	1	1
T	0	2			
A	0				
A	0				

j = 2, i = 2:

$$S(2,2) = \max \begin{cases} S(1,1) + 3 + 1 = 4 \\ S(1,2) + -1 = 2 - 1 = 1 \\ S(2,1) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 1 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 4$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3	2	1	1
T	0	2	4		
A	0				
A	0				

j = 2, i = 3:

$$S(2,3) = \max \begin{cases} S(1,2) + 2 + 3 = 5 \\ S(1,3) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ S(2,2) + -1 = 4 - 1 = 3 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 5$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3	2	1	1
T	0	2	4	5	
A	0				
A	0				

j = 2, i = 4:

$$S(2,4) = \max \begin{cases} S(1,3) + 1 + 1 = 2 \\ S(1,4) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ S(2,3) + -1 = 5 - 1 = 4 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 4$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3	2	1	1
T	0	2	4	5	4
A	0				
A	0				

Continue like that...

j = 2, i = 4:

$$S(4,4) = \max \begin{cases} S(3,3) + 3 = 5 + 3 = 8 \\ S(3,4) + -1 = 8 - 1 = 7 \\ S(4,3) + -1 = 4 - 1 = 3 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 8$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3	2	1	1
T	0	2	4	5	4
A	0	1	3	5	8
A	0	1	2	4	8

Result

Score = 8 made up out of:

- Match G G
- Mismatch C T
- Mismatch T A
- Match A A

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3	2	1	1
T	0	2	4	5	4
A	0	1	3	5	8
A	0	1	2	4	8

11.3 | Waterman-Eggert Example

Input

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	3	2	1	1
T	0	2	4	5	4
A	0	1	3	5	8
A	0	1	2	4	8

Take the calculated matrix from Smith-Waterman and set all cells that contribute to the optimal alignment to 0.

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	0	2	1	1
T	0	2	0	5	4
A	0	1	3	0	8
A	0	1	2	4	0

Main part - calculation
 $i_{start} \leftarrow 1$
for $i \leftarrow i_{start}$ to n **do**
for $j \leftarrow 1$ to m **do**
if (i, j) belongs to optimal alignment **then**
 $S(i, j) = 0$
else

$$S(i, j) \leftarrow \max \begin{cases} 0 \\ S(i-1, j-1) + s(x[i], y[j]) \\ S(i-1, j) - s(x[i], -) \\ S(i, j-1) - s(-, y[j]) \end{cases}$$

end if
end for
end for

i = 1, j = 1: (1,1) belongs to optimal alignment, also $S(i-1, j-1) + s(x[i], y[j]) = 0$ bzw. dieser Weg darf nicht gegangen werden.

Und über den Rest bekommt man auch maximal 0, da:

$$S(1, 1) \leftarrow \max \begin{cases} 0 \\ S(0, 1) - 1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ S(1, 0) - 1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \end{cases}$$

i = 1, j = 2:

$$S(1, 2) = \max \begin{cases} S(0, 1) + 1 = 0 + 1 = 1 \\ S(0, 2) + -1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ S(1, 1) + -1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 1$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	0	1	1	1
T	0	2	0	5	4
A	0	1	3	0	8
A	0	1	2	4	0

i = 1, j = 3:

$$S(1,3) = \max \begin{cases} S(0,2) + 1 = 0 + 1 = 1 \\ S(0,3) + -1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ S(1,2) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 1$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	2	0	5
A		0	1	3	0
A		0	1	2	4

i = 1, j = 4:

$$S(1,4) = \max \begin{cases} S(0,3) + 1 = 0 + 1 = 1 \\ S(0,4) + -1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ S(1,3) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 1$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	2	0	5
A		0	1	3	0
A		0	1	2	4

i = 2, j = 1:

$$S(2,1) = \max \begin{cases} S(1,0) + 1 = 0 + 1 = 1 \\ S(1,1) + -1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ S(2,0) + -1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 1$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	1	0	5
A		0	1	3	0
A		0	1	2	4

i = 2, j = 2: (2,2) belongs to optimal alignment, also $S(i-1, j-1) + s(x[i], y[j]) = 0$ bzw. dieser Weg darf nicht gegangen werden.

Und über den Rest bekommt man auch maximal 0, da:

$$S(2,2) \leftarrow \max \begin{cases} 0 \\ S(1,2) - 1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ S(2,1) - 1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \end{cases}$$

i = 2, j = 3:

$$S(2,3) = \max \begin{cases} S(1,2) + 3 = 1 + 3 = 4 \\ S(1,3) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ S(2,2) + -1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 4$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	1	0	4
A		0	1	3	0
A		0	1	2	4

i = 2, j = 4:

$$S(2,4) = \max \begin{cases} S(1,3) + 1 = 1 + 1 = 2 \\ S(1,4) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ S(2,3) + -1 = 4 - 1 = 3 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 3$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	1	0	4
A		0	1	3	0
A		0	1	2	4

i = 3, j = 1:

$$S(3,1) = \max \begin{cases} S(2,0) + 1 = 0 + 1 = 1 \\ S(2,1) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ S(3,0) + -1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 1$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	1	0	4
A		0	1	3	0
A		0	1	2	4

i = 3, j = 2:

$$S(3,2) = \max \begin{cases} S(2,1) + 1 = 1 + 1 = 2 \\ S(2,2) + -1 = 1 - 1 = -1 \\ S(3,1) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 2$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	1	0	4
A		0	1	2	0
A		0	1	2	4

i = 3, j = 3: (3,3) belongs to optimal alignment
 $\Rightarrow S(3,3) = 0$

Aber über den Rest bekommt man 3, da:

$$S(3,3) \leftarrow \max \begin{cases} 0 \\ S(2,3) - 1 = 4 - 1 = 3 \\ S(3,2) - 1 = 2 - 1 = 1 \end{cases}$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	1	0	4
A		0	1	2	3
A		0	1	2	4

i = 3, j = 4:

$$S(3,4) = \max \begin{cases} S(2,3) + 3 = 4 + 3 = 7 \\ S(2,4) + -1 = 3 - 1 = 2 \\ S(3,3) + -1 = 3 - 1 = 2 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 7$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	1	0	4
A		0	1	2	3
A		0	1	2	4

i = 4, j = 1:

$$S(4,1) = \max \begin{cases} S(3,0) + 1 = 0 + 1 = 1 \\ S(3,1) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ S(4,0) + -1 = 0 - 1 = -1 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 1$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	1	0	4
A		0	1	2	3
A		0	1	2	4

i = 4, j = 2:

$$S(4,2) = \max \begin{cases} S(3,1) + 1 = 1 + 1 = 2 \\ S(3,2) + -1 = 2 - 1 = 1 \\ S(4,1) + -1 = 1 - 1 = 0 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 2$$

i \ j		G	C	T	A
		0	0	0	0
G		0	0	1	1
T		0	1	0	4
A		0	1	2	3
A		0	1	2	4

$i = 4, j = 3$:

$$S(4,3) = \max \begin{cases} S(3,2) + 2 + 1 = 3 \\ S(3,3) + -1 = 3 - 1 = 2 \\ S(4,2) + -1 = 2 - 1 = 1 \\ 0 \end{cases} = 3$$

$i \setminus j$		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	0	1	1	1
T	0	1	0	4	3
A	0	1	2	3	7
A	0	1	2	3	0

$i = 4, j = 4$: (4,4) belongs to optimal alignment

Aber über den Rest bekommt man 6, da:

$$S(4,4) \leftarrow \max \begin{cases} 0 \\ S(3,4) - 1 = 7 - 1 = 6 \\ S(4,3) - 1 = 3 - 1 = 2 \end{cases}$$

$i \setminus j$		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	0	1	1	1
T	0	1	0	4	3
A	0	1	2	3	7
A	0	1	2	3	6

Result

$i \setminus j$		G	C	T	A
	0	0	0	0	0
G	0	0	1	1	1
T	0	1	0	4	3
A	0	1	2	3	7
A	0	1	2	3	6

Links

- <https://www.compbio.dundee.ac.uk/papers/water/node5.html>
- <https://w.wiki/ZAL>
- <https://rna.informatik.uni-freiburg.de/Teaching/index.jsp?toolName=Smith-Waterman>

WARNUNG: man kann zwar bei eggert das erste Alignment nicht mehr nehmen, aber es könnte dort trotzdem noch ein Indel sein.

Backmatter

Definitionen

***q*-gram** . vi, 3, 5–10, 15

alignment distance The alignment distance of two sequences $x, y \in \Sigma^*$ is defined as $d(x, y) := \min\{\text{cost}(A) : A \in \mathcal{A}^* \text{ is an alignment of } x \text{ and } y\}$. 5

alphabet encoding ranking function . 6–9

approximate string matching problem todo. 23

background frequencies Die Einträge des frequency vector π ; gewinnbar als Randverteilungen (Marginals) von M_t : $\pi_a = \sum_{b \in \Sigma} M_t(a, b)$ und $\pi_b = \sum_{a \in \Sigma} M_t(a, b)$ (wegen Symmetrie). 31

bidirected de Bruijn subgraph Erweitert den klassischen de-Bruijn-Graphen, indem jedes k -Mer mit seinem Reverse-Komplement identifiziert wird. Beide Sequenzen werden somit durch denselben Knoten repräsentiert. Diese Darstellung berücksichtigt, dass bei DNA-Sequenzierungen häufig nicht bekannt ist, von welchem Strang der DNA-Doppelhelix ein Read stammt. Die übrige Struktur des de-Bruijn-Graphen, insbesondere die Definition der Kanten, bleibt unverändert.. 19

bidirectional indices Textindizes, die einen partiellen Match flexibel *sowohl nach links als auch nach rechts* verlängern können, wie es Search Schemes erfordern. Beispiele: Affix-Bäume/-Arrays, bidirektionale BWT, bidirektionaler Wavelet-Index, br-index, bidirektionaler Move-Index. 27

colored de Bruijn subgraph Erweitert den de-Bruijn-Graphen um Informationen über die Herkunft der k -Mere. Hierzu werden die Eingabesequenzen in mehrere Gruppen, beispielsweise verschiedene Genome oder Datensätze, unterteilt. Jeder Gruppe wird eine Farbe zugewiesen. Ein Knoten erhält die Menge aller Farben der Gruppen, in denen das entsprechende k -Mer vorkommt. Dadurch lässt sich nachvollziehen, in welchen Sequenzmengen ein k -Mer enthalten ist. Colored de-Bruijn-Graphen eignen sich insbesondere für den Vergleich mehrerer Genome, erfordern jedoch aufgrund der Speicherung der Farbinformationen deutlich mehr Speicher als klassische de-Bruijn-Graphen.. 20, 21

compacted de Bruijn subgraph Entsteht durch das Zusammenfassen nicht verzweigender Pfade eines de-Bruijn-Graphen. Besitzt eine Folge aufeinanderfolgender Knoten jeweils genau einen Nachfolger und einen Vorgänger (mit Ausnahme der Endknoten), so wird diese zu einem einzelnen Knoten, einem sogenannten *Unitig*, zusammengefasst. Dieser repräsentiert ein längeres Teilstück der ursprünglichen Sequenz. Durch diese Kompaktierung werden Speicherbedarf und häufig auch die Laufzeit nachfolgender Algorithmen reduziert, ohne dass die wesentliche Struktur des Graphen verloren geht.. 20

de Bruijn graph The graph that contains one vertex for each k -mer (and therefore σ^k vertices) and a directed edge for each overlap of length $k - 1$ (and therefore σ^{k+1} edges). 18

de Bruijn subgraph The de Bruijn subgraph $DBG(s, k) = (V, E)$ for a given sequence s of dimension k (positive integer $\leq |s|$) is a directed multigraph whose vertices V correspond to the distinct k -mers of s , $s_{k,1}, \dots, s_{k,|s|-k+1}$, and whose edges are derived from the $(k + 1)$ -mers of s as follows: Let a $(k + 1)$ -mer of s be denoted as

$s[i \dots i + k] = aub$, where a and b are symbols and $|u| = k - 1$, then a directed edge is contained in E , linking vertex au to vertex ub . [iv](#), [15](#), [16](#), [18–21](#)

dense . [6](#)

dimension of a de Bruijn subgraph The positive integer $\leq |s|$ in a $DBG(s, k) = (V, E)$. [15](#)

edit distance ... [5](#), [10](#), [12](#), [13](#)

eulerian path . [16](#)

fixed evolutionary time period Zeitraum t , über den die Ersetzung einzelner Aminosäuren verfolgt wird. t ist so zu wählen, dass die Score-Matrix zum Problem passt: Für Sequenzen mit gemeinsamem Vorfahren vor $\approx t/2$ sollte eine aus Paaren mit Divergenz t konstruierte Matrix genutzt werden. [31](#)

frequency vector Vektor $\pi = (\pi_a)_{a \in \Sigma}$ der natürlich vorkommenden Aminosäuren mit $\pi_a \geq 0$ für alle $a \in \Sigma$ und $\sum_{a \in \Sigma} \pi_a = 1$. Für zwei zufällige Positionen ist die Wahrscheinlichkeit des geordneten Paares (a, b) gleich $\pi_a \cdot \pi_b$. [31](#)

general similarity score Allgemeine Ähnlichkeitsfunktion, bei der Matches positiv, Mismatches und Indels negativ bewertet werden – im Gegensatz zu einem Distanzmodell, in dem ein Match stets Kosten 0 hat. Nützlich insbesondere fürs lokale Alignment, wo Distanzfunktionen ungeeignet sind. [30](#)

k-approximate matches $i^*(C) := \max\{i \mid C(i) \leq k\}$. [23](#)

last essential index todo. [25](#)

left-to-right partition $Plr(x, y) = (z_0, \langle b_1 \rangle, z_1, \langle b_2 \rangle, \dots, z_{\ell-1}, \langle b_\ell \rangle, z_\ell)$ of x with respect to y is the partition defined by the condition that for all $i \in [1, \ell]$, $z_{i-1}b_i$ is not a substring of y . [11](#), [12](#)

likelihood ratio Verhältnis $M_t(a, b)/(\pi_a \cdot \pi_b)$, das die Wahrscheinlichkeit des Paares (a, b) im Evolutionsmodell zu der im Zufallsmodell in Beziehung setzt. Werte > 1 bedeuten Ähnlichkeit, Werte < 1 Unähnlichkeit von a und b . [31](#)

log-odds score matrix Additive Score-Matrix bzgl. Zeitraum t , definiert als Logarithmus der likelihood ratio: $\text{score}_t(a, b) := \log\left(\frac{M_t(a, b)}{\pi_a \cdot \pi_b}\right)$. Wichtige Familien: PAM(t) und BLOSUM(s). [31](#)

maximal matches distance $\delta(x||y) := \min\{|P| : P \text{ is a partition of } x \text{ with respect to } y\}$. [11–13](#)

MinU search scheme Search Scheme (Renders et al., 2024), dessen Fehlerbereiche $(L[i], U[i])$ langsamer wachsen als beim pigeonhole-Schema und das daher effizienter ist. Es ist *lossless*, d.h. kein Match mit bis zu k Fehlern wird verpasst (alle Fehlerkonfigurationen $(e_1, \dots, e_p)$ mit $\sum e_i \leq k$ sind abgedeckt). [27](#)

occurrence count Let $x \in \Sigma^m$ and choose $q \in [1, m]$. The occurrence count of a q -gram $z \in \Sigma^q$ in x is the number $Occ(x, z) := |\{i \in [1, m - q + 1] : x[i \dots i + q - 1] = z\}|$. [6](#)

pigeonhole principle search scheme Zerlegt das Muster x bei Fehlerschwelle k in $p = k + 1$ Teile $x_1, \dots, x_{k+1}$. Da bei $\leq k$ Fehlern mindestens ein Teil exakt vorkommen muss, besteht das Schema aus $k + 1$ Suchen S_i : Teil x_i exakt matchen, dann Backtracking nach links und rechts bis insgesamt k Fehler erreicht sind. [26](#)

q-gram distance The q -gram distance of $x \in \Sigma^m$ and $y \in \Sigma^n$ is defined for $1 \leq q \leq \min\{m, n\}$ as: $d_q(x, y) := \sum_{z \in \Sigma^q} |p_q(x)_z - p_q(y)_z|$. [v](#), [5](#), [6](#), [8–10](#), [12](#), [13](#), [15](#)

q-gram profile Let $\sigma = |\Sigma|$. The q-gram profile of x is a σ^q -element vector $p_q(x) := (p_q(x)_z)_{z \in \Sigma^q}$, indexed by all q-grams, defined by $p_q(x)_z := \text{Occ}(x, z)$. [vi](#), [6](#), [8](#), [15](#)

ranking algorithm An algorithm that implements a [ranking function](#). [6](#)

ranking function A bijective function $r : \mathcal{X} \rightarrow [0, |\mathcal{X}| - 1]$ for a finite set $\mathcal{X}$. [v](#), [vi](#), [6](#), [7](#), [9](#), [10](#)

right-to-left partition $\text{Prl}(x, y) = (z_0, \langle b_1 \rangle, z_1, \dots, \langle b_{\ell} \rangle, z_{\ell})$ of x with respect to y is the partition defined by the condition that for all $i \in [1, \ell]$, $b_i z_i$ is not a substring of y . [12](#)

sensible score function Funktion $\text{score} : \mathcal{A}(\Sigma) \rightarrow \mathbb{R}$ mit $\text{score}\left(\binom{a}{a}\right) \geq 0 \geq \text{score}\left(\binom{a}{-}\right) = \text{score}\left(\binom{-}{a}\right)$, $\text{score}\left(\binom{a}{a}\right) \geq \text{score}\left(\binom{a}{c}\right) = \text{score}\left(\binom{c}{a}\right)$ und $\text{score}\left(\binom{a}{c}\right) \geq \text{score}\left(\binom{a}{-}\right) + \text{score}\left(\binom{-}{c}\right)$ (Symmetrie; Selbst-Ähnlichkeit maximal; Substitution besser als Deletion+Insertion). [30](#)

third-bits Score-Einheit: Ein Score ist in *bits*, wenn er per $\log_2(\cdot)$ gebildet wird; wird er zusätzlich mit dem Faktor 3 multipliziert (und gerundet), erhält man Scores in third-bits. [32](#)

transversion/transition cost Biologisch motivierte Kostenfunktion auf dem DNA-Alphabet: Purin/Purin- und Pyrimidin/Pyrimidin-Ersetzungen (Transitionen) kosten 1, Purin/Pyrimidin-Ersetzungen (Transversionen) kosten 2; oft mit Indel-Kosten 3. Reflektiert, dass Transitionen wahrscheinlicher sind als Transversionen. [29](#)

unranking algorithm An algorithm that implements a [unranking function](#). [6](#)

unranking function The inverse of a [ranking function](#). [v](#), [6](#)

11.4 | List of equations

Wichtig

- **Q-gram distance** (page [6](#), equation [\(1.2\)](#))

$$d_q(x, y) := \sum_{z \in \Sigma^q} |p_q(x)_z - p_q(y)_z|$$

- **Ranking:**

- **Rising ranking function** (page [7](#), equation [\(1.4\)](#))

$$r(z) = \sum_{i=1}^q r_{\Sigma}(z[i]) \cdot \Sigma^{i-1}$$

- **Falling ranking function** (page [7](#), equation [\(1.3\)](#))

$$r(z) = \sum_{i=1}^q r_{\Sigma}(z[i]) \cdot \sigma^{q-i}$$

- **Rising unranking function** (page [8](#), equation [\(1.6\)](#))

$$\frac{r}{\sigma} = r', \quad \mathbf{R} \ c$$

- **Falling unranking function** (page [8](#), equation [\(1.5\)](#))

$$\frac{r}{\sigma^{q-1}} = c, \quad \mathbf{R} \ r'$$

Nicht wichtig zu lernen, da intuitiv

- Occurrence count

11.5 | Algorithms

Name	Aufgabe	Laufzeit	Speicherplatz
Ranking function	Aufgabe TODO	$O(q)$	-
Q-gram profile	Aufgabe	$O(\#q\text{-grams} + m + n)$ or $O(n)$ if $m \leq n$ and $q =$ $\left\lceil \frac{\log(m) \log(c)}{\log(\sigma)} \right\rceil$	$O(\#q\text{-grams})$

11.5.1 | Detailed time complexities

Aspect	Complexity	Because...
Initialise empty array of q-gram profile	$O(\#entries)$	1 step per entry (= q-gram)
Count <i>q-grams</i> in string <i>x</i> of length <i>m</i> (create q-gram profile of <i>x</i>)	$O(m)$	compute hash of first <i>q-gram</i> in $O(m)$, then use rolling hash to update in $O(1)$ for each remaining position
Initialize q-gram distance variable	$O(1)$	trivial
Summarize something (e.g. absolute differences for the occurrence counts)	$O(\#entries)$	Iteration through entries, 1 step per entry

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Bibliography

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- [2] Wikipedia contributors. *Approximate string matching* — *Wikipedia, The Free Encyclopedia*. [Online; accessed 31-July-2026]. 2026. URL: https://en.wikipedia.org/w/index.php?title=Approximate_string_matching&oldid=1351934189.